FINANCIAL ACCOUNTING & ANALYSIS

MAJOR PROJECT REPORT

Industry Study: Paints & Coatings

A Comparative Financial Accounting and Ratio Analysis of Five Listed Indian Paints & Coatings Companies

Berger Paints India Ltd. | Kansai Nerolac Paints Ltd. | Asian Paints Ltd. | Indigo Paints Ltd. | JSW Dulux Ltd. (formerly Akzo Nobel India Ltd.)

Team Members	Company Chosen
Sachi Jain (R012)	Berger Paints India Ltd.
Vidisha Kondinya (R016)	Asian Paints Ltd.
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Arnav Rathod (R031)	Kansai Nerolac Paints Ltd.
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MBA Tech (Artificial Intelligence)

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Introduction

This report is the group major project for Financial Accounting & Analysis (FAA). It studies five listed Indian paints and coatings companies, using their published financial statements and market data, to compare how each company has performed and how each one stands against the industry.

Companies studied. The five companies, in the order used throughout this report, are Berger Paints India Ltd., Asian Paints Ltd., Indigo Paints Ltd., JSW Dulux Ltd. (formerly Akzo Nobel India Ltd.) and Kansai Nerolac Paints Ltd.

Period covered. The financial analysis compares the two financial years ended 31 March 2025 (FY2024-25) and 31 March 2026 (FY2025-26). The share price analysis uses monthly closing prices from April 2021 to March 2026, and market capitalisation is shown as of 9 October 2026.

Data and sources. The financial statement figures are taken from the companies' annual reports for FY2024-25 and FY2025-26. Share prices, market capitalisation and the ratios come from the accompanying Excel workbook. The annual report pages that carry the statements are reproduced in the Annexure (Section 9).

Method. For each company the report works out the liquidity, leverage, profitability, efficiency and growth ratios and the 3-factor and 5-factor DuPont analysis of return on equity, and compares each company with the Industry Average. The Industry Average is the simple mean of the five companies.

A note on the figures. JSW Dulux's FY2025-26 profit includes a one-off exceptional gain, and Kansai Nerolac's FY2024-25 profit also included one. These affect the profit-based ratios and the Industry Average, and the report points this out where it matters.

How the report is organised. Section 1 gives the company profiles and Section 2 the industry profile. Section 3 ranks the five companies as leaders and laggards, and Section 4 covers share price performance and market capitalisation. Section 5 sets out the financial statement data, Section 6 the ratio analysis with graphs, and Section 7 interprets the ratios. Section 8 lists the references and Section 9 is the Annexure with the annual report pages.

1. Company Profile

This section presents the company profile of each of the five companies studied: the NIC code, corporate headquarters location, date of incorporation, Chairman and CEO, and dividend history.

Table 1: Company Profile of the Five Companies Studied

Particulars	Berger Paints India Limited	Asian Paints Limited	Indigo Paints Limited	JSW Dulux Limited (formerly Akzo Nobel India Limited)	Kansai Nerolac Paints Limited
Detail common to all five companies (stated once)					
NIC Code	20221 - Manufacture of paints, varnishes, enamels or lacquers (NIC 2008)				
Company-specific details					
CIN	L51434WB1923PLC004793	L24220MH1945PLC004598	L24114PN2000PLC014669	L24292WB1954PLC021516	L24202MH1920PLC000825
Registered Office	Berger House, 129 Park Street, Kolkata, West Bengal 700017	6A & 6B, Shantinagar, Santacruz (East), Mumbai, Maharashtra 400055	Indigo Tower, Street-5, Pallod Farm-2, Baner Road, Pune, Maharashtra 411045	801A South City Business Park, Eastern Metropolitan Bypass, Kolkata, West Bengal 700107	28th Floor, A-Wing, Marathon Futurex, N M Joshi Marg, Lower Parel, Mumbai, Maharashtra 400013
Corporate Headquarters	Berger House, 129 Park Street, Kolkata, West Bengal 700017	6A & 6B, Shantinagar, Santacruz (East), Mumbai, Maharashtra 400055	Indigo Tower, Street-5, Pallod Farm-2, Baner Road, Pune, Maharashtra 411045	JSW Centre, Bandra Kurla Complex, Mumbai 400051 (effective 1 April 2026)	28th Floor, A-Wing, Marathon Futurex, N M Joshi Marg, Lower Parel, Mumbai, Maharashtra 400013
Date of Incorporation	17 December 1923	24 October 1945	28 March 2000	12 March 1954	2 September 1920
Chairman	Rishma Kaur - Non-Executive Chairman; Kuldip Singh Dhingra - Chairman-Emeritus	R Seshasayee - Non-Executive Chairman, Independent Director	Hemant Jalan - Chairman & Managing Director (Promoter)	Parth Jindal - Non-Executive Chairman (since January 2026)	Bhaskar Bhat - Chairman, Independent Director
CEO / Managing Director	Abhijit Roy - Managing Director & CEO	Amit Syngle - Managing Director & CEO	Hemant Jalan - Chairman & Managing Director	Rajiv Rajgopal - Joint Managing Director & CEO	Pravin D. Chaudhari - Managing Director (w.e.f. 1 April 2025)
Dividend History (₹ per share, year-wise)					
Dividend - FY 2021-22	₹ 3.10 - Paid	₹ 19.15 - Paid	₹ 3.00 - Paid	₹ 75.00 - Paid	₹ 2.25 - Paid
Dividend - FY 2022-23	₹ 3.20 - Paid	₹ 25.65 - Paid	₹ 3.50 - Paid	₹ 65.00 - Paid	₹ 2.70 - Paid
Dividend - FY 2023-24	₹ 3.50 - Paid	₹ 33.30 - Paid	₹ 3.50 - Paid	₹ 75.00 - Paid	₹ 3.75 - Paid
Dividend - FY 2024-25	₹ 3.80 - Paid	₹ 24.80 - Paid	₹ 3.50 - Paid	₹ 100.00 - Paid	₹ 3.75 - Paid
Dividend - FY 2025-26	₹ 4.00 - Approved*	₹ 27.50 - Paid+Approved* - ₹4.50 interim (Paid, 27 Nov 2025) + ₹23.00 final (Approved, 9 Jul 2026 AGM; payment not independently confirmed)	₹ 5.00 - Approved*	₹ 206.00 - Paid+Approved** - ₹156.00 special interim (Paid; declared by the Board on 4 August 2025) + ₹50.00 final (Approved, 72nd AGM 10 Jul 2026; payment not independently confirmed)	₹ 2.50 - Approved*

*Dividend status shown as of 12 October 2026. Four stages are distinguished here: "Approved" = shareholders voted yes on the resolution at the AGM, making the dividend a binding payment obligation, but it has not been confirmed from a primary source that the funds were actually credited to shareholders, "Paid" = confirmed credited to shareholders by a primary source (a company filing, investor communication, or stock-exchange announcement), "Paid+Approved" means part of the total (an interim or special dividend) is confirmed paid while the remaining final tranche is approved but not independently confirmed as paid.

Source pages. The annual report pages used for Table 1 are listed in Section 9 (Annexure), together with the other sources.

2. Industry Profile

2.1 Sector and Industry

The five companies belong to the Materials sector, which covers companies that manufacture chemicals and chemical products. Within this sector, the industry is Paints and Coatings. Its NIC-2008 code is 20221, "Manufacture of paints and varnishes, enamels or lacquers", under Division 20 (Manufacture of chemicals and chemical products). Paint companies are therefore treated as manufacturers and not as retailers, even though they sell through dealers. All five companies report the same NIC code in their FY2025-26 Annual Reports.

2.2 What Makes a Company Part of This Industry

Similar products and services. A company belongs to this industry when it makes and sells paints, varnishes, enamels, lacquers and similar coatings. There are two types of products: decorative paints (wall paints, wood finishes, primers, putties, waterproofing) and industrial or protective coatings (for cars, factories and anti-corrosion use). All five companies sell both, but in different proportions.

Market. Decorative paints are sold mostly through dealers and paint shops to homeowners and contractors. Industrial coatings are sold directly to businesses such as car makers and infrastructure companies.

Regulations. All five companies follow the same Bureau of Indian Standards norms, for example IS 2932 for synthetic enamels and IS 5411 for emulsion paints. They are also all moving towards low-VOC, water-based paints, which adds compliance and reformulation costs for the whole industry.

Response to the economy. Demand for decorative paints depends on house building, renovation and how much consumers are willing to spend. Industrial coatings depend on factory output and company spending on new capacity. The main raw materials (titanium dioxide, resins and solvents) are linked to crude oil prices, so margins across the industry rise and fall with them.

2.3 The Five Companies

Berger Paints India Ltd. Berger mainly sells decorative paints such as interior and exterior wall paints, wood finishes, enamels, primers and putties. It also has a smaller industrial and protective coatings business. It sells through a large network of dealers and paint stores and was incorporated in 1923.

Asian Paints Ltd. Asian Paints has the biggest dealer and retail network of the five companies. Besides decorative paints, it sells home décor and waterproofing products. It was incorporated in 1945.

Indigo Paints Ltd. Indigo focuses on decorative paints. Its dealer network is newer and smaller than those of Berger and Asian Paints. It was incorporated in 2000, which makes it the youngest of the five.

JSW Dulux Ltd. (formerly Akzo Nobel India Ltd.) JSW Dulux makes decorative and protective coatings under the Dulux brand and sells them through dealers and retail stores like the others. Akzo Nobel India was bought by JSW Paints (JSW Group) and renamed JSW Dulux Limited on 11 March 2026. The company was incorporated in 1954.

Kansai Nerolac Paints Ltd. Kansai Nerolac has a large automotive and industrial coatings business along with its decorative paints. Part of its sales are direct contracts with businesses, so it depends more on vehicle production and industrial activity than the other four. It was incorporated in 1920.

3. Industry Leaders and Laggards

The leaders and laggards are chosen only from the five companies in this project, so the ranking is relative to this group and not to the whole Indian paints industry. Each company is ranked from 1 to 5 on four measures: market capitalisation (size), operating profit margin for FY2025-26 (profitability), revenue growth for FY2025-26 (growth) and share price return over the five years from April 2021 to March 2026 (market performance). The two companies with the lowest total are the leaders and the two with the highest total are the laggards. All figures come from the Excel workbook, and market capitalisation is as of 9 October 2026.

Table 2: Industry Leaders and Laggards Among the Five Companies

Company	Market Cap (₹ Cr) (rank)	Operating Profit Margin FY2025-26 (rank)	Revenue Growth FY2025-26 (rank)	5-Year Price Return (rank)	Total	Role
Asian Paints	224,365.96 (1)	16.56% (1)	+4.12% (2)	-14.63% (2)	6	**Leader**
Berger Paints	55,023.67 (2)	12.87% (3)	+2.47% (4)	-30.11% (3)	12	**Leader**
Indigo Paints	6,286.00 (5)	14.38% (2)	+4.14% (1)	-69.30% (5)	13	**Middle**
JSW Dulux	13,367.00 (4)	12.01% (4)	-12.03% (5)	+32.49% (1)	14	**Laggard**
Kansai Nerolac	14,663.72 (3)	9.88% (5)	+3.24% (3)	-54.71% (4)	15	**Laggard**

Operating profit margin and revenue growth are the workbook's own calculations. Price return is from the April 2021 close to the March 2026 close and excludes dividends. Rank 1 is the best.

Leaders. Asian Paints has the lowest total (6). It is first on size and operating margin (16.56%) and second on growth and price return. Berger Paints (12) is second on size, third on margin and price return, and has revenue growth of +2.47%, the second lowest of the five.

Laggards. Kansai Nerolac has the highest total (15). It has the lowest operating margin (9.88%), a price fall of 54.71% and middling revenue growth (+3.24%). JSW Dulux (14) has the weakest growth, with revenue down 12.03%, and its operating margin is 12.01%. Its share price rose 32.49%, the best of the five, which keeps it out of last place, but the price may also reflect the ownership change to JSW Paints.

Middle. Indigo Paints (13) falls between the groups. It is the smallest company and its share price fell the most (69.30%), but it has the highest revenue growth (+4.14%) and the second-best operating margin (14.38%). Its total is only one point better than JSW Dulux, so the laggard ranking is close.

4. Stock Performance and Market Capitalisation

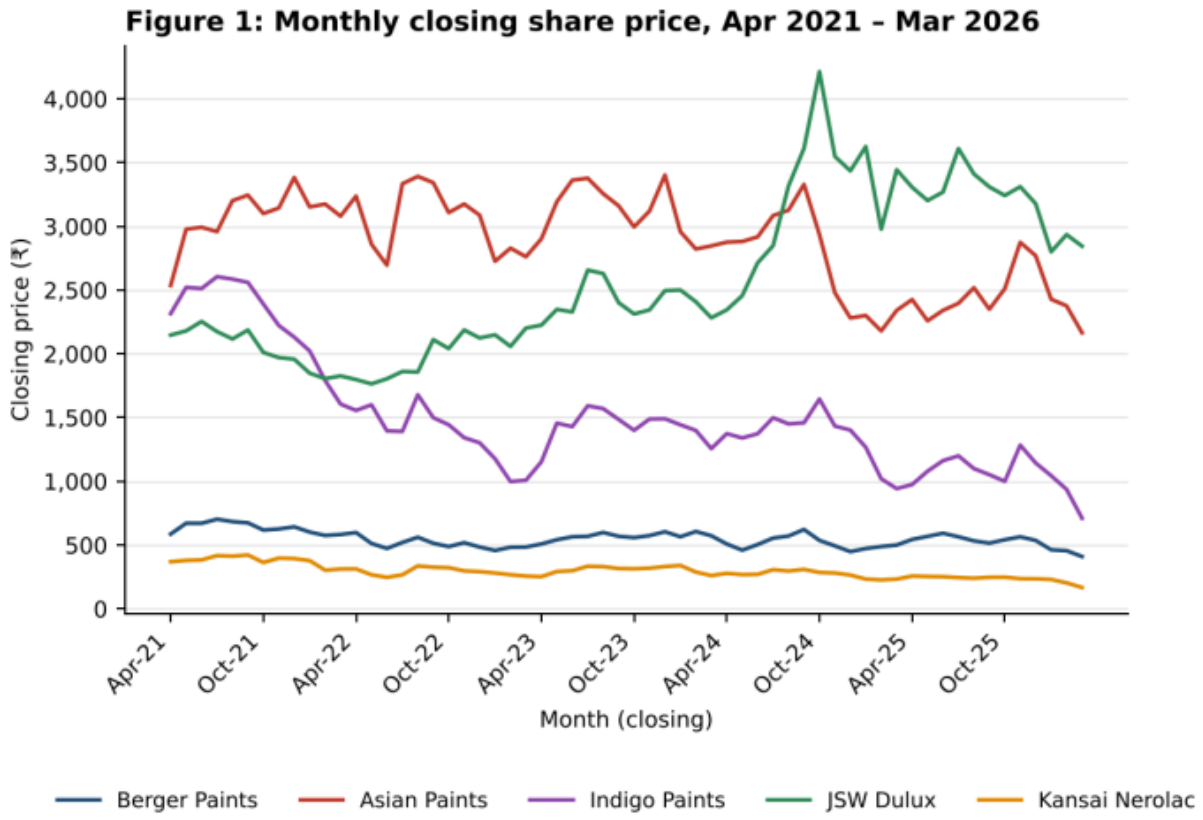
This section compares the share price and market capitalisation of all five companies. The share prices are the monthly closing prices from April 2021 to March 2026 (FY2021-22 to FY2025-26), taken from the Excel workbook, which derived them from NSE/BSE daily historical data. The workbook holds one closing price per month, not every daily price, so the tables and graphs use monthly values. Each table is given first, and the graph below it is drawn from that table. Market capitalisation is as of 9 October 2026 (source: Screener.in). Figures 1, 2 and 4 are the three main graphs (price, return and market capitalisation). Figure 3 shows the total return over the full period and Figure 5 shows each company's share of revenue.

4.1 Share Price Comparison

Table 3: Monthly Closing Share Price (₹), April 2021 – March 2026

Month	Berger Paints	Asian Paints	Indigo Paints	JSW Dulux	Kansai Nerolac
Apr-21	586.67	2,536.40	2,315.50	2,147.14	369.22
May-21	671.29	2,977.50	2,521.35	2,180.11	379.91
Jun-21	670.92	2,992.70	2,512.55	2,253.82	383.47
Jul-21	702.96	2,958.45	2,605.10	2,174.51	417.30
Aug-21	684.00	3,201.35	2,585.95	2,116.79	413.03
Sep-21	674.17	3,244.65	2,560.25	2,186.57	422.17
Oct-21	617.92	3,100.10	2,390.35	2,010.98	363.37
Nov-21	626.46	3,143.65	2,222.40	1,970.58	397.50
Dec-21	643.12	3,382.95	2,130.75	1,957.90	394.13
Jan-22	602.00	3,152.25	2,022.60	1,848.16	378.00
Feb-22	575.37	3,174.65	1,790.65	1,805.37	303.10
Mar-22	583.08	3,079.95	1,605.85	1,826.86	311.83
Apr-22	598.29	3,237.20	1,556.00	1,798.05	313.03
May-22	512.42	2,859.65	1,600.35	1,764.26	266.80
Jun-22	473.58	2,695.20	1,395.65	1,804.46	247.00
Jul-22	520.58	3,333.75	1,391.70	1,861.75	266.67
Aug-22	561.42	3,391.60	1,679.25	1,857.58	336.87
Sep-22	514.17	3,342.45	1,499.40	2,111.24	326.43
Oct-22	488.17	3,107.70	1,443.80	2,041.03	322.57
Nov-22	518.67	3,175.15	1,342.25	2,186.96	297.61
Dec-22	484.46	3,087.90	1,302.60	2,124.55	291.54
Jan-23	457.63	2,725.85	1,177.15	2,148.81	280.85
Feb-23	483.00	2,828.80	998.30	2,058.40	267.28
Mar-23	484.75	2,761.65	1,008.35	2,202.08	256.73
Apr-23	508.63	2,902.35	1,153.55	2,225.20	252.31
May-23	542.04	3,192.95	1,456.25	2,348.63	292.60
Jun-23	565.08	3,362.05	1,428.90	2,328.72	298.97
Jul-23	568.67	3,377.35	1,592.35	2,656.41	333.92
Aug-23	598.83	3,256.10	1,570.30	2,629.90	331.18
Sep-23	568.85	3,161.05	1,485.80	2,401.22	316.05
Oct-23	558.60	2,995.70	1,400.00	2,312.83	313.71
Nov-23	574.40	3,119.90	1,488.65	2,344.51	318.83
Dec-23	604.65	3,402.40	1,490.50	2,495.84	331.78
Jan-24	565.15	2,957.85	1,443.45	2,500.39	340.24
Feb-24	606.70	2,821.90	1,398.85	2,408.40	288.32
Mar-24	573.05	2,846.75	1,256.60	2,282.63	261.09
Apr-24	508.55	2,875.90	1,373.95	2,344.99	278.51
May-24	460.00	2,881.20	1,340.30	2,455.74	268.41
Jun-24	504.20	2,917.05	1,373.00	2,714.04	270.10
Jul-24	554.90	3,084.45	1,498.95	2,848.47	307.20
Aug-24	571.05	3,126.80	1,450.50	3,316.83	296.50
Sep-24	622.30	3,329.10	1,459.20	3,612.03	309.50
Oct-24	536.80	2,935.65	1,645.40	4,213.87	285.10
Nov-24	493.70	2,479.60	1,433.55	3,548.52	280.95
Dec-24	448.55	2,281.35	1,402.05	3,435.14	265.00
Jan-25	472.75	2,300.80	1,267.20	3,625.96	233.10
Feb-25	488.55	2,179.75	1,019.85	2,977.12	226.66
Mar-25	500.20	2,340.65	942.70	3,443.99	232.90
Apr-25	544.20	2,425.70	974.75	3,306.45	257.17
May-25	568.30	2,259.10	1,079.45	3,202.59	253.70
Jun-25	592.65	2,341.10	1,162.20	3,269.11	252.15
Jul-25	564.90	2,396.10	1,200.00	3,609.97	244.90
Aug-25	533.00	2,518.60	1,099.70	3,410.60	239.99
Sep-25	515.20	2,350.00	1,052.20	3,309.50	247.38
Oct-25	542.10	2,510.80	999.90	3,241.70	247.96
Nov-25	564.60	2,874.40	1,283.65	3,310.80	236.49
Dec-25	536.55	2,769.50	1,143.80	3,177.30	235.45
Jan-26	462.90	2,428.30	1,044.40	2,800.00	230.19
Feb-26	456.10	2,376.20	936.80	2,935.30	203.51
Mar-26	410.00	2,165.20	710.80	2,844.70	167.22

Closing prices as recorded in the Excel workbook (source: NSE/BSE historical data).

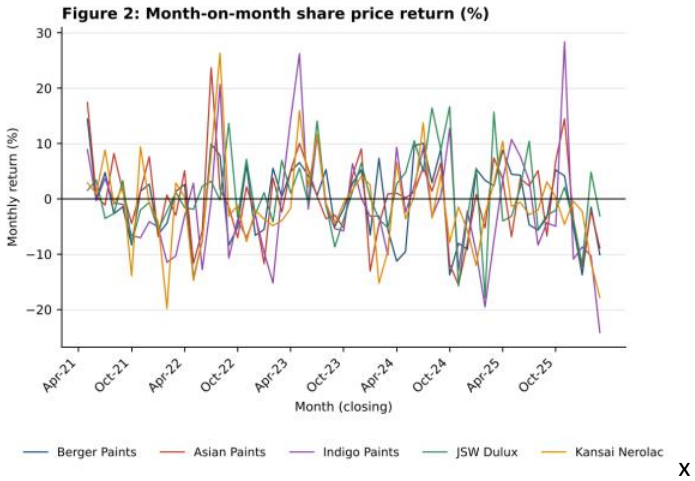


4.2 Monthly and Cumulative Returns

Table 4: Month-on-Month Share Price Return (%), May 2021 – March 2026

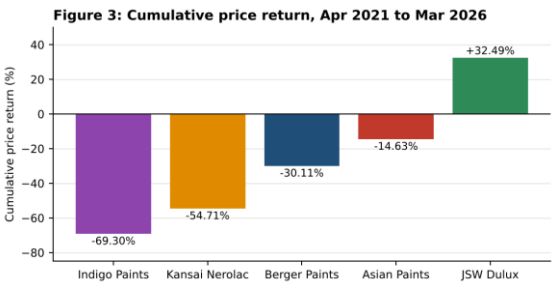
Month	Berger Paints	Asian Paints	Indigo Paints	JSW Dulux	Kansai Nerolac
Apr-21	-	-	-	-	-
May-21	14.42	17.39	8.89	1.54	2.90
Jun-21	-0.06	0.51	-0.35	3.38	0.94
Jul-21	4.78	-1.14	3.68	-3.52	8.82
Aug-21	-2.70	8.21	-0.74	-2.65	-1.02
Sep-21	-1.44	1.35	-0.99	3.30	2.21
Oct-21	-8.34	-4.46	-6.64	-8.03	-13.93
Nov-21	1.38	1.40	-7.03	-2.01	9.39
Dec-21	2.66	7.61	-4.12	-0.64	-0.85
Jan-22	-6.39	-6.82	-5.08	-5.60	-4.09
Feb-22	-4.42	0.71	-11.47	-2.32	-19.81
Mar-22	1.34	-2.98	-10.32	1.19	2.88
Apr-22	2.61	5.11	-3.10	-1.58	0.38
May-22	-14.35	-11.66	2.85	-1.88	-14.77
Jun-22	-7.58	-5.75	-12.79	2.28	-7.42
Jul-22	9.92	23.69	-0.28	3.17	7.96
Aug-22	7.85	1.74	20.66	-0.22	26.32
Sep-22	-8.42	-1.45	-10.71	13.66	-3.10
Oct-22	-5.06	-7.02	-3.71	-3.33	-1.18
Nov-22	6.25	2.17	-7.03	7.15	-7.74
Dec-22	-6.60	-2.75	-2.95	-2.85	-2.04
Jan-23	-5.54	-11.72	-9.63	1.14	-3.67
Feb-23	5.54	3.78	-15.19	-4.21	-4.83
Mar-23	0.36	-2.37	1.01	6.98	-3.95
Apr-23	4.93	5.09	14.40	1.05	-1.72
May-23	6.57	10.01	26.24	5.55	15.97
Jun-23	4.25	5.30	-1.88	-0.85	2.18
Jul-23	0.64	0.46	11.44	14.07	11.69
Aug-23	5.30	-3.59	-1.38	-1.00	-0.82
Sep-23	-5.01	-2.92	-5.38	-8.70	-4.57
Oct-23	-1.80	-5.23	-5.77	-3.68	-0.74
Nov-23	2.83	4.15	6.33	1.37	1.63
Dec-23	5.27	9.05	0.12	6.45	4.06
Jan-24	-6.53	-13.07	-3.16	0.18	2.55
Feb-24	7.35	-4.60	-3.09	-3.68	-15.26
Mar-24	-5.55	0.88	-10.17	-5.22	-9.44
Apr-24	-11.26	1.02	9.34	2.73	6.67
May-24	-9.55	0.18	-2.45	4.72	-3.63
Jun-24	9.61	1.24	2.44	10.52	0.63
Jul-24	10.06	5.74	9.17	4.95	13.74
Aug-24	2.91	1.37	-3.23	16.44	-3.48
Sep-24	8.97	6.47	0.60	8.90	4.38
Oct-24	-13.74	-11.82	12.76	16.66	-7.88
Nov-24	-8.03	-15.53	-12.88	-15.79	-1.46
Dec-24	-9.15	-8.00	-2.20	-3.20	-5.68
Jan-25	5.40	0.85	-9.62	5.55	-12.04
Feb-25	3.34	-5.26	-19.52	-17.89	-2.76
Mar-25	2.38	7.38	-7.56	15.68	2.75
Apr-25	8.80	3.63	3.40	-3.99	10.42
May-25	4.43	-6.87	10.74	-3.14	-1.35
Jun-25	4.28	3.63	7.67	2.08	-0.61
Jul-25	-4.68	2.35	3.25	10.43	-2.88
Aug-25	-5.65	5.11	-8.36	-5.52	-2.00
Sep-25	-3.34	-6.69	-4.32	-2.96	3.08
Oct-25	5.22	6.84	-4.97	-2.05	0.23
Nov-25	4.15	14.48	28.38	2.13	-4.63
Dec-25	-4.97	-3.65	-10.89	-4.03	-0.44
Jan-26	-13.73	-12.32	-8.69	-11.87	-2.23
Feb-26	-1.47	-2.15	-10.30	4.83	-11.59
Mar-26	-10.11	-8.88	-24.12	-3.09	-17.83

Return = (this month's closing price ÷ previous month's closing price − 1) × 100. April 2021 has no earlier month, so no retu rn is shown.



x

Figure 3 shows the total price return over the full period, from the April 2021 close to the March 2026 close, excluding dividends.



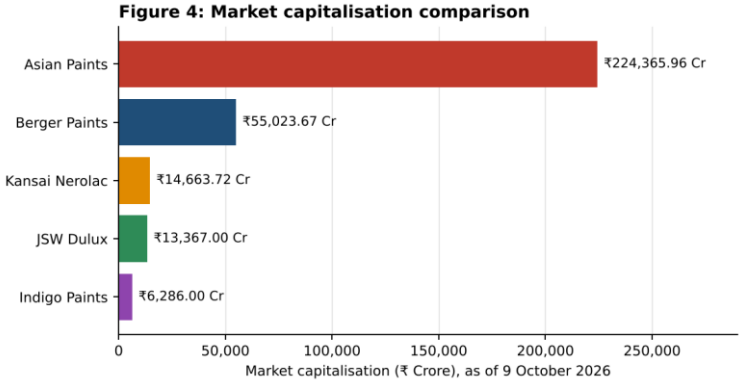
4.3 Market Capitalisation Comparison

Table 5: Market Capitalisation and Price Return Summary

Company	Market Cap (₹ Cr)	Share of Combined Market Cap	Apr-21 (₹) ,Price	Mar-26 (₹) ,Price	Cumulative Price Return
Asian Paints	224,365.96	71.5%	2,536.40	2,165.20	-14.63%
Berger Paints	55,023.67	17.5%	586.67	410.00	-30.11%
Kansai Nerolac	14,663.72	4.7%	369.22	167.22	-54.71%
JSW Dulux	13,367.00	4.3%	2,147.14	2,844.70	+32.49%
Indigo Paints	6,286.00	2.0%	2,315.50	710.80	-69.30%

Market capitalisation as of 9 October 2026. Cumulative price return excludes dividends.

Figure 4: Market capitalisation comparison



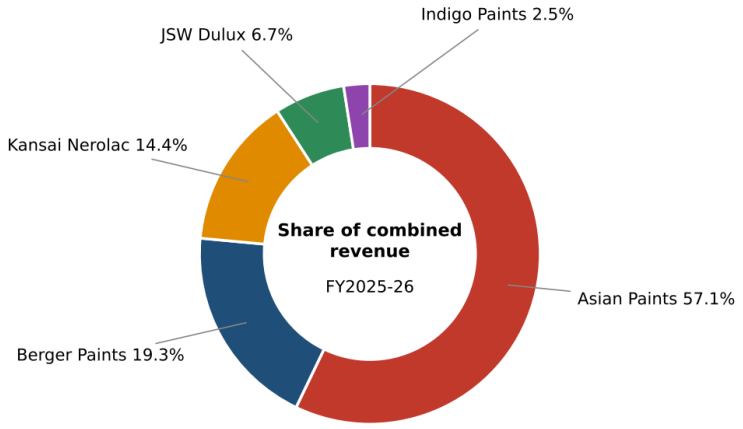
4.4 Market Share of the Five Companies

Table 6: Revenue Share of the Five Companies

Company	Revenue from Operations, FY2025-26 (₹ Cr)	Share of Five-Company Revenue (this report)	Share of Top-5 Revenue, FY24 (ACMIIL Research)
Asian Paints	30,769.48	57.1%	59.4%
Berger Paints	10,420.10	19.3%	18.7%
Kansai Nerolac	7,739.23	14.4%	13.1%
JSW Dulux	3,599.20	6.7%	6.6%
Indigo Paints	1,330.12	2.5%	2.2%
Total	**53,858.13**	**100.0%**	**100.0%**

Revenue is standalone Revenue from Operations from the Excel workbook (JSW Dulux as regrouped in the FY2025-26 report). The ACMIIL column is the FY24 share of the top five paint companies' consolidated revenue (Exhibit 4, ACMIIL Institutional Research, Paints – Sector Initiating Report, based on company filings; JSW Dulux is shown there as Akzo Nobel India).

Figure 5: Revenue share of the five companies



The doughnut shows each company's share of the combined revenue of the five companies, which is a practical measure of market share for this project. Asian Paints has the largest share (57.1%), followed by Berger Paints (19.3%) and Kansai Nerolac (14.4%), while JSW Dulux (6.7%) and Indigo Paints (2.5%) are the smallest. The shares are close to the independent FY24 figures from ACMIIL Research (59.4%, 18.7%, 13.1%, 6.6% and 2.2%), which supports the ranking and the rough size of each share.

Some websites quote a share of the whole Indian paint industry, for example Asian Paints at about 50–52% and Berger Paints at about 18–20%. Those figures include smaller and unorganised players, do not state their basis or year, and differ between websites, so they are not used in the chart. A whole-market chart with an "others" slice would need a reliable industry revenue total, which is not available in the Excel workbook.

4.5 Discussion

Stock performance. Asian Paints and JSW Dulux traded at the highest price levels (Asian Paints roughly ₹2,165–3,402, JSW Dulux ₹1,764–4,214), while Berger Paints (₹410–703) and Kansai Nerolac (₹167–422) traded much lower. A high price per share does not mean a bigger company, so the better measure is the return. Over the five years, only JSW Dulux gave a positive price return (+32.49%). Asian Paints fell 14.63%, Berger Paints 30.11%, Kansai Nerolac 54.71% and Indigo Paints 69.30%. Indigo Paints was the most volatile share, with monthly returns ranging from -24.12% to +28.38%, against -14.35% to +14.42% for Berger Paints. Berger Paints stayed the most stable of the five.

Investor confidence. Asian Paints kept its price within a fairly high band and lost the least of the four companies that fell, which suggests steadier investor confidence in the market leader. Berger Paints also held up better than Kansai Nerolac and Indigo Paints. Indigo Paints started at ₹2,315, peaked at ₹2,605 in July 2021 and then fell almost every year to ₹711 in March 2026, the weakest result of the five. JSW Dulux is the only share that ended higher than it started, but its price may also have been moved by the JSW Paints acquisition, so the price alone is not a clean sign of confidence in the business. Price levels also depend on shares outstanding, so they are only one indicator.

Market position. Asian Paints is far ahead, with a market capitalisation of ₹2,24,365.96 Cr, which is 71.5% of the combined value of the five companies and about four times Berger Paints (₹55,023.67 Cr). Berger Paints is a clear second (17.5%). Kansai Nerolac (₹14,663.72 Cr), JSW Dulux (₹13,367.00 Cr) and Indigo Paints (₹6,286.00 Cr) form a much smaller group, together 10.9% of the total. The two largest companies by market capitalisation, Asian Paints and Berger Paints, are also the two leaders in the leaders and laggards' section.

Possible reasons. These are possible reasons drawn from the Excel figures and the companies' business, not proven causes. They are grouped under four headings.

Profitability. In FY2025-26 Asian Paints had the highest operating profit margin (16.56%) and a net profit margin of 13.79% with an ROE of 21.35%, which supports its position as the leader. Berger Paints earned a net margin of 10.51% and an ROE of 18.22%, but its operating margin slipped from 13.34% to 12.87%. Indigo Paints improved its operating margin from 13.92% to 14.38%. Kansai Nerolac is the weakest: its net margin fell from 13.62% to 8.01%, its operating margin from 10.41% to 9.88%, and its ROE is only 9.49%. JSW Dulux shows a net margin of 53.28% and an ROE of 103.02%, but this comes from a one-off gain on the sale of two divisions. Its operating margin, which leaves out that gain, fell from 13.49% to 12.01%.

Business growth. Revenue growth in FY2025-26 was +4.14% for Indigo Paints, +4.12% for Asian Paints, +3.24% for Kansai Nerolac and +2.47% for Berger Paints. JSW Dulux's revenue fell 12.03%. Asian Paints'

revenue fell 5.36% in FY2024-25 before it recovered, so its growth has not been smooth. Growth alone did not decide the share price: Indigo Paints grew fastest but its share fell the most.

Industry trends. Paint makers buy raw materials that are linked to crude oil, so prices and margins move with oil prices, and this affects all five companies. Demand also depends on housing, repainting and, for Kansai Nerolac, on the automotive and industrial segments, which are more cyclical. The fall in operating margins at Berger Paints, Kansai Nerolac and JSW Dulux is consistent with these cost pressures, but the workbook does not prove the cause.

Strategic decisions. Asian Paints has the widest dealer network and the strongest brand in the industry, which supports its price and size. Berger Paints has grown by adding dealers and moving into waterproofing, which fits with its more stable share. Kansai Nerolac depends more on automotive and industrial paints. Indigo Paints is the youngest and smallest of the five. JSW Dulux is going through the ownership change to JSW Paints and sold two divisions, which explains its one-off gain and its lower revenue.

4.6 Summary of Competitive Standing

Asian Paints is the clear leader in size and has held its share price better than most peers. Berger Paints is a strong second and the steadiest share. Kansai Nerolac and JSW Dulux are the laggards in this group: Kansai Nerolac has the lowest operating margin and its share fell 54.71%, while JSW Dulux has the weakest revenue growth even though its share rose 32.49%. Indigo Paints is the smallest and its share lost the most value over the five years.

5. Financial Statement Data

Amounts in ₹ Crore, from the Excel five-company book values table. JSW Dulux's FY2025-26 profit before tax includes a ₹1,846.3 Cr exceptional gain (sale of two divisions).

Table 7: Financial Statement Data of the Five Companies (₹ Crore, standalone)

Line item (₹ Crore)	Berger Paints India Ltd.		Asian Paints Ltd.		Indigo Paints Ltd.		JSW Dulux Ltd.		Kansai Nerolac Paints Ltd.	
	FY2024-25	FY2025-26	FY2024-25	FY2025-26	FY2024-25	FY2025-26	FY2024-25	FY2025-26	FY2024-25	FY2025-26
Reporting basis	₹ Crore as reported (standalone)		₹ Crore; FY2024-25 as originally published (restated in FY2025-26 report)		Reported in ₹ lakh; converted to ₹ Crore (÷100)		Reported in ₹ million; converted to ₹ Crore (÷10); FY2024-25 revenue regrouped		₹ Crore as reported; exceptional items in both years	
Inventories (closing stock)	2,206.60	2,225.60	5,848.23	4,824.74	149.13	173.07	604.70	571.10	1,609.71	1,492.92
Trade Receivables (current)	1,124.37	1,129.27	3,197.55	3,227.71	219.92	257.29	584.90	602.90	1,274.70	1,379.83
Cash & Cash Equivalents	141.39	151.94	176.19	395.38	37.09	28.54	247.20	203.10	85.72	184.12
Bank Balances other than Cash & Cash Equivalents	224.46	55.01	26.09	50.96	0.01	0.01	52.30	53.90	174.52	7.97
Other Current Assets (investments, loans, other)	436.98	1,118.69	5,039.88	8,757.44	240.14	304.26	511.30	289.40	2,029.11	2,549.88
Total Current Assets	**4,133.80**	**4,680.51**	**14,287.94**	**17,256.23**	**646.29**	**763.17**	**2,000.40**	**1,720.40**	**5,173.76**	**5,614.72**
Trade Payables	1,569.34	1,522.26	3,123.69	3,114.48	165.29	199.44	956.60	753.60	1,023.65	1,075.42
Short-term Borrowings	0.39	0.00	2.15	340.73	0.00	0.00	0.00	0.00	0.00	0.00
Other Current Liabilities & Provisions	416.03	619.85	3,090.36	3,550.67	104.19	143.48	493.60	380.70	263.68	422.77
Total Current Liabilities	**1,985.76**	**2,142.11**	**6,216.20**	**7,005.88**	**269.48**	**342.92**	**1,450.20**	**1,134.30**	**1,287.33**	**1,498.19**
Total Borrowings (excl. lease liabilities)	**0.39**	**0.00**	**39.40**	**1,189.67**	**0.00**	**0.00**	**0.00**	**0.00**	**0.00**	**0.00**
Total Equity / Shareholders' Funds	**5,681.06**	**6,342.90**	**18,983.48**	**20,781.56**	**1,048.14**	**1,182.35**	**1,328.70**	**2,394.20**	**6,366.23**	**6,695.77**
Total Assets	**8,176.51**	**8,946.20**	**26,653.11**	**30,084.26**	**1,357.77**	**1,569.93**	**2,901.60**	**3,728.40**	**7,969.24**	**8,538.59**
Revenue from Operations	10,169.22	10,420.10	29,552.65	30,769.48	1,277.19	1,330.12	4,091.20	3,599.20	7,496.71	7,739.23
Cost of Materials Consumed	5,252.79	5,222.80	13,238.32	12,670.79	648.64	662.20	2,162.50	1,868.20	4,357.87	4,382.20
Profit Before Tax	1,430.74	1,438.22	4,897.18	5,733.60	192.23	195.27	569.70	2,299.70	1,386.61	838.21
Tax Expense	353.24	342.56	1,312.30	1,489.43	48.29	49.88	141.10	382.00	365.37	218.36
Profit for the Year (PAT)	**1,077.50**	**1,095.66**	**3,584.88**	**4,244.17**	**143.94**	**145.39**	**428.60**	**1,917.70**	**1,021.24**	**619.85**
Exceptional Items, net gain/(charge) - in PBT	0.00	-49.99	-379.63	-166.53	0.00	-5.85	0.00	1,846.30	479.19	-60.70
Profit Before Exceptional Items & Tax (memo)	1,430.74	1,488.21	5,276.81	5,900.13	192.23	201.12	569.70	453.40	907.42	898.91
Total Lease Liabilities, Ind AS 116 (memo)	**492.10**	**458.74**	**1,159.42**	**1,179.29**	**19.70**	**18.38**	**62.10**	**79.10**	**171.20**	**217.20**
Total Expenses (incl. finance costs, depreciation)	**8,860.69**	**9,124.76**	**25,045.99**	**25,802.01**	**1,102.42**	**1,141.21**	**3,549.10**	**3,179.10**	**6,731.35**	**6,992.78**
Finance Costs (Standalone)	47.86	45.60	143.77	127.35	2.96	2.39	9.80	12.10	15.09	18.41
Opening balances - FY2023-24 closing	**FY2023-24**		**FY2023-24**		**FY2023-24**		**FY2023-24**		**FY2023-24**	
Inventories (closing stock)	2,019.43		5,155.59		166.20		611.50		1,616.04	
Total Equity / Shareholders' Funds	5,005.24		18,288.66		915.07		1,329.20		5,653.12	
Total Assets	7,581.66		26,035.64		1,221.95		2,903.00		7,224.80	
Revenue from Operations (growth base year)	10,002.93		31,226.98		1,254.86		3,961.60		7,393.30	

Inference. Asian Paints is by far the largest company on every line: in FY2025-26 its revenue was ₹30,769.48 Cr and its profit ₹4,244.17 Cr, against ₹10,420.10 Cr and ₹1,095.66 Cr for Berger Paints. Indigo Paints is the smallest, with revenue of ₹1,330.12 Cr. JSW Dulux's FY2025-26 profit (₹1,917.70 Cr) is far above its FY2024-25 profit (₹428.60 Cr) even though its revenue fell from ₹4,091.20 Cr to ₹3,599.20 Cr, because of the ₹1,846.30 Cr exceptional gain. Kansai Nerolac's profit fell from ₹1,021.24 Cr to ₹619.85 Cr, but its FY2024-25 figure included a ₹479.19 Cr exceptional gain; before exceptional items its profit before tax was almost unchanged (₹907.42 Cr and ₹898.91 Cr).

6. Ratio Analysis

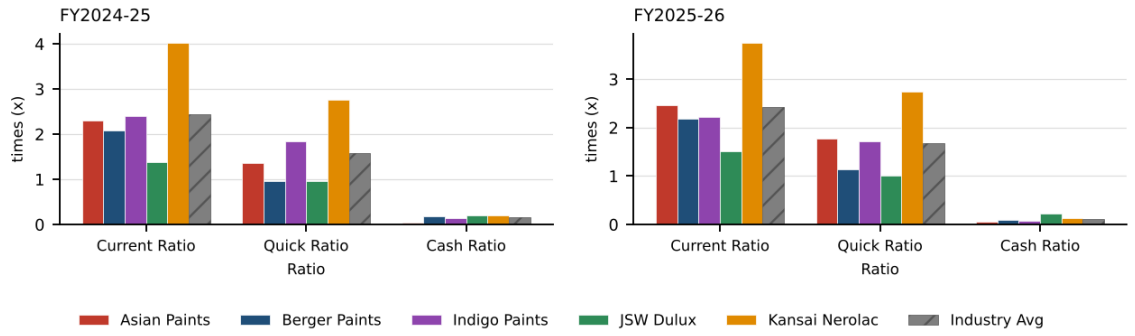
The ratios are taken from the Excel workbook submitted with this writeup and shown group by group. Each table gives the formula used and the figures for Asian Paints, Berger Paints, Indigo Paints, JSW Dulux and Kansai Nerolac, followed by the Industry Average, with a blank column between each. The Industry Average is the simple mean of the five companies. A graph follows each table, drawn from the same figures. ROA, ROE, asset turnover, equity multiplier and materials-consumption turnover use average balances; FY2024-25 uses the FY2023-24 opening balances.

6.1 Liqidity Analysis

Table 8: Liquidity

Ratio	Formula used	Asian Paints		Berger Paints		Indigo Paints		JSW Dulux		Kansai Nerolac		Industry Avg	
		FY2024-25	FY2025-26	FY2024-25	FY2025-26	FY2024-25	FY2025-26	FY2024-25	FY2025-26	FY2024-25	FY2025-26	FY2024-25	FY2025-26
Current Ratio	Current Assets ÷ Current Liabilities	2.30x	2.46x	2.08x	2.18x	2.40x	2.23x	1.38x	1.52x	4.02x	3.75x	2.44x	2.43x
Quick Ratio	(Current Assets − Inventories) ÷ Current Liabilities	1.36x	1.77x	0.97x	1.15x	1.84x	1.72x	0.96x	1.01x	2.77x	2.75x	1.58x	1.68x
Cash Ratio	(Cash & Cash Equivalents + Other Bank Balances) ÷ Current Liabilities	0.03x	0.06x	0.18x	0.10x	0.14x	0.08x	0.21x	0.23x	0.20x	0.13x	0.15x	0.12x

Figure 6: Liquidity ratios: five companies and Industry Average



Source: Table 8 above; Excel workbook, Industry Summary sheet. Industry Avg = mean of the five companies.

Inference: All five companies can cover their short-term liabilities, since every current ratio is above 1. Kansai Nerolac is the most liquid (4.02x and 3.75x) and JSW Dulux the least (1.38x and 1.52x). Asian Paints improved on all three measures, with its quick ratio rising from 1.36x to 1.77x. Berger Paints and JSW Dulux had quick ratios below 1 in FY2024-25 and only just above 1 in FY2025-26. Cash ratios are low for most companies and fell for Berger Paints, Indigo Paints and Kansai Nerolac. The Industry Average current ratio was almost unchanged (2.44x and 2.43x).

Table 9: Liquidity Analysis, FY2024-25 → FY2025-26

Company	Current ratio	Quick ratio	Cash ratio	Change in liquidity
Asian Paints	2.30x → 2.46x	1.36x → 1.77x	0.03x → 0.06x	Increased
Berger Paints	2.08x → 2.18x	0.97x → 1.15x	0.18x → 0.10x	Increased (cash ratio fell)
Indigo Paints	2.40x → 2.23x	1.84x → 1.72x	0.14x → 0.08x	Decreased
JSW Dulux	1.38x → 1.52x	0.96x → 1.01x	0.21x → 0.23x	Increased (still lowest)
Kansai Nerolac	4.02x → 3.75x	2.77x → 2.75x	0.20x → 0.13x	Decreased slightly (still highest)

Summary

- Three companies improved liquidity (Asian Paints, Berger Paints and JSW Dulux), while Indigo Paints and Kansai Nerolac eased.
- All five still have current ratios above 1, Kansai Nerolac is the most liquid and JSW Dulux the least.
- Cash ratios fell for Berger Paints, Indigo Paints and Kansai Nerolac, so the gains came from short-term investments and from lower liabilities, not from more cash.

Asian Paints

Change in Liquidity

- Liquidity increased.
- The current ratio rose from 2.30x to 2.46x and the quick ratio from 1.36x to 1.77x, moving from below the industry average in FY2024-25 (2.44x and 1.58x) to slightly above it in FY2025-26 (2.43x and 1.68x).
- The main reason is inventory: it fell 17.5% (₹5,848.23 Cr to ₹4,824.74 Cr), so the improvement is real liquidity and not stock building up.
- The cash ratio doubled from 0.03x to 0.06x but is still well below the industry average (0.15x and 0.12x).

Impact on Short-Term Operations and Long-Term Stability

- A quick ratio above 1 means Asian Paints can pay its short-term liabilities (₹7,005.88 Cr in FY2025-26) from receivables, cash and short-term investments without selling stock, so day-to-day operations are not under pressure.
- It runs with little cash, which fits a company of this size that manages working capital tightly.
- Over the long term, the improvement together with equity of ₹20,781.56 Cr gives a stable position, although the low cash cover means it relies on steady collections and supplier credit.

Berger Paints

Change in Liquidity

- Liquidity increased on the current and quick ratios but not on cash.
- The current ratio rose from 2.08x to 2.18x and the quick ratio from 0.97x to 1.15x, crossing above 1 for the first time in this period.
- Current assets grew 13.2% (₹4,133.80 Cr to ₹4,680.51 Cr) against 7.9% for current liabilities, while inventory grew only 0.9%.
- The growth came from other current assets (short-term investments), which rose from ₹436.98 Cr to ₹1,118.69 Cr.
- The cash ratio fell from 0.18x to 0.10x because cash and bank balances dropped from ₹365.85 Cr to ₹206.95 Cr, which points to cash being moved into short-term investments.

Impact on Short-Term Operations and Long-Term Stability

- A quick ratio above 1 means Berger Paints can now meet its short-term liabilities without selling inventory, which supports day-to-day operations.
- The quality of the gain is a little lower than the headline ratios suggest because immediately available cash cover fell.
- Berger Paints stays below the industry average on both main ratios in both years (the industry average current ratio is 2.44x and 2.43x), partly because Kansai Nerolac holds a large amount of short-term investments.
- With almost no borrowing, long-term stability is not at risk.

Indigo Paints

Change in Liquidity

- Liquidity decreased.
- The current ratio eased from 2.40x to 2.23x and the quick ratio from 1.84x to 1.72x.
- Current liabilities grew 27.3% (₹269.48 Cr to ₹342.92 Cr), faster than current assets at 18.1% (₹646.29 Cr to ₹763.17 Cr).
- Trade payables rose from ₹165.29 Cr to ₹199.44 Cr, which is consistent with a growing business using more supplier credit.
- The cash ratio fell from 0.14x to 0.08x as cash dropped from ₹37.09 Cr to ₹28.54 Cr.

Impact on Short-Term Operations and Long-Term Stability

- Both ratios are still well above 1, so Indigo Paints can meet its short-term obligations comfortably.
- Because it has no interest-bearing borrowings, no debt payments compete with working capital for its cash, which is why liquidity can ease without raising solvency concerns.
- For the long term, the thing to watch is the falling cash balance as the business keeps growing.

JSW Dulux

Change in Liquidity

- Liquidity increased, but it remains the lowest of the five.
- The current ratio rose from 1.38x to 1.52x, the quick ratio from 0.96x to 1.01x (above 1 for the first time here) and the cash ratio from 0.21x to 0.23x.
- Current liabilities fell 21.8% (₹1,450.20 Cr to ₹1,134.30 Cr), more than current assets, which fell 14.0%.
- Trade payables dropped from ₹956.60 Cr to ₹753.60 Cr.
- Both sides of the balance sheet shrank in FY2025-26, the year it sold two divisions.

Impact on Short-Term Operations and Long-Term Stability

- A quick ratio of only 1.01x leaves little headroom: JSW Dulux can meet its short-term liabilities, but with a thinner margin than Berger Paints or Kansai Nerolac, and it is below the industry average on both ratios.
- For the long term, equity rose 80.2% to ₹2,394.20 Cr and there are no borrowings, so solvency is not a concern, but this rise in equity comes mainly from the one-off gain.

Kansai Nerolac

Change in Liquidity

- Liquidity decreased slightly but is still the highest of the five.
- The current ratio fell from 4.02x to 3.75x and the quick ratio was almost flat (2.77x to 2.75x).

- Current liabilities grew 16.4% (₹1,287.33 Cr to ₹1,498.19 Cr) against 8.5% for current assets.
- The cash ratio fell from 0.20x to 0.13x because other bank balances dropped from ₹174.52 Cr to ₹7.97 Cr, while other current assets rose from ₹2,029.11 Cr to ₹2,549.88 Cr, so cash appears to have moved into other short-term investments.

Impact on Short-Term Operations and Long-Term Stability

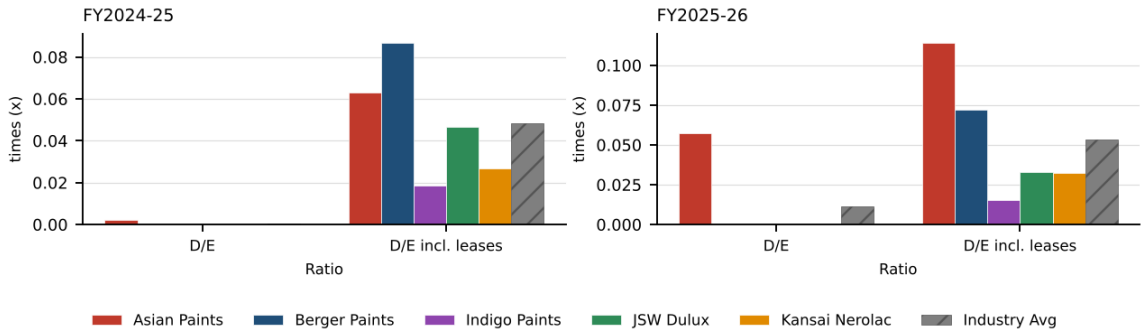
- Short-term operations are not at risk: current assets are about 3.75 times current liabilities and no borrowings need to be repaid.
- The long-term question is a different one: whether this much money held in investments and inventory is the most productive use of capital for growth.

6.2 Leverage Analysis

Table 10: Solvency and Leverage

Ratio	Formula used	Asian Paints		Berger Paints		Indigo Paints		JSW Dulux		Kansai Nerolac		Industry Avg	
		FY2024-25	FY2025-26	FY2024-25	FY2025-26	FY2024-25	FY2025-26	FY2024-25	FY2025-26	FY2024-25	FY2025-26	FY2024-25	FY2025-26
Debt-to-Equity	Total Borrowings ÷ Total Equity	0.00x	0.06x	0.00x	0.00x	0.00x	0.00x	0.00x	0.00x	0.00x	0.00x	0.00x	0.01x
Debt-to-Equity (incl. Lease Liabilities)	(Total Borrowings + Total Lease Liabilities) ÷ Total Equity	0.06x	0.11x	0.09x	0.07x	0.02x	0.02x	0.05x	0.03x	0.03x	0.03x	0.05x	0.05x

Figure 7: Solvency and leverage ratios



Source: Table 10 above; Excel workbook, Industry Summary sheet. Industry Avg = mean of the five companies.

Inference: Borrowing is very low across the group. Debt-to-Equity is close to zero for every company except Asian Paints, where it rose from 0.00x to 0.06x in FY2025-26 as its total borrowings increased from ₹39.40 Cr to ₹1,189.67 Cr. Including lease liabilities, Asian Paints rose from 0.06x to 0.11x, while Berger Paints, Indigo Paints and JSW Dulux moved down and Kansai Nerolac moved slightly up. None of the five relies on debt, so the financial risk from leverage is small.

Table 11: Leverage Analysis, FY2024-25 → FY2025-26

Company	Debt-to-Equity	Debt-to-Equity with leases	Total borrowings (₹ Cr)	Change in leverage
Asian Paints	0.00x → 0.06x	0.06x → 0.11x	₹39.40 → ₹1,189.67	Increased
Berger Paints	0.00x → 0.00x	0.09x → 0.07x	₹0.39 → ₹0.00	No change; lower with leases
Indigo Paints	0.00x → 0.00x	0.02x → 0.02x	₹0.00 → ₹0.00	No change; lower with leases
JSW Dulux	0.00x → 0.00x	0.05x → 0.03x	₹0.00 → ₹0.00	No change; lower with leases (one-off equity rise)
Kansai Nerolac	0.00x → 0.00x	0.03x → 0.03x	₹0.00 → ₹0.00	No change; slightly higher with leases

Summary

- All five companies carry very little debt.
- Only Asian Paints added borrowings (₹39.40 Cr to ₹1,189.67 Cr).
- With leases included, the ratios of Berger Paints, Indigo Paints and JSW Dulux fell and Kansai Nerolac's rose slightly, so no company faces a financial-risk problem from debt, and all five have room to borrow.

Asian Paints

Change in Leverage (Debt-to-Equity)

- Leverage increased.
- Debt-to-Equity rose from 0.00x to 0.06x (0.0021x to 0.0572x), and including lease liabilities from 0.06x to 0.11x.
- Total borrowings rose from ₹39.40 Cr to ₹1,189.67 Cr, and short-term borrowings from ₹2.15 Cr to ₹340.73 Cr.
- On the lease-inclusive measure Asian Paints is above the industry average in both years (0.06x against 0.05x in FY2024-25, and 0.11x against 0.05x in FY2025-26).

Impact on Financial Risk, Long-Term Obligations and Short-Term Financing

- Financial risk has risen, but from a very low base, since borrowings are small next to equity of ₹20,781.56 Cr.
- For long-term obligations there is still ample room to borrow more.
- The new short-term borrowings suggest Asian Paints may now be using debt for working capital or seasonal needs instead of relying only on internal cash, which is worth watching if it continues.

Berger Paints

Change in Leverage (Debt-to-Equity)

- Leverage did not change on the usual measure and fell slightly with leases included.
- Debt-to-Equity was 0.00x in both years (borrowings ₹0.39 Cr then ₹0.00 Cr).
- Including leases it fell from 0.09x to 0.07x, because lease liabilities eased from ₹492.10 Cr to ₹458.74 Cr while equity grew from ₹5,681.06 Cr to ₹6,342.90 Cr.
- On the lease-inclusive measure Berger Paints is above the industry average in both years (0.09x against 0.05x in FY2024-25, and 0.07x against 0.05x in FY2025-26).

Impact on Financial Risk, Long-Term Obligations and Short-Term Financing

- Financial risk is low, but leases are a real fixed obligation, so Berger Paints is not quite as debt-free as the plain ratio suggests.
- It has plenty of room to borrow for long-term needs, and short-term funding comes from internal cash and supplier credit instead of bank loans.

Indigo Paints

Change in Leverage (Debt-to-Equity)

- Leverage did not change on the usual measure and fell slightly with leases included.
- Debt-to-Equity was 0.00x in both years, as Indigo Paints has no interest-bearing borrowings.
- Including leases it moved from 0.0188x to 0.0155x, as lease liabilities eased from ₹19.70 Cr to ₹18.38 Cr and equity grew from ₹1,048.14 Cr to ₹1,182.35 Cr.
- This is the lowest of the five on the lease-inclusive measure in both years.

Impact on Financial Risk, Long-Term Obligations and Short-Term Financing

- Financial risk is very low, and growth so far has been funded from equity and internal cash.
- That leaves a lot of untapped borrowing capacity if it wants to expand faster, and short-term needs are met entirely from its own resources.
- Borrowing is a tool it has not yet needed.

JSW Dulux

Change in Leverage (Debt-to-Equity)

- The usual Debt-to-Equity stayed at 0.00x, and with leases it fell from 0.05x to 0.03x.
- The fall comes from equity rising 80.2%, from ₹1,328.70 Cr to ₹2,394.20 Cr, mainly because the FY2025-26 divestment gain was retained, while lease liabilities rose from ₹62.10 Cr to ₹79.10 Cr.
- It is therefore a one-off effect of the gain, not a decision to reduce debt.

Impact on Financial Risk, Long-Term Obligations and Short-Term Financing

- Financial risk is low and there is a lot of room for long-term borrowing, and no short-term bank borrowing is needed.
- The comfort is partly on paper, because it depends on the one-off gain staying in equity.

Kansai Nerolac

Change in Leverage (Debt-to-Equity)

- The usual Debt-to-Equity stayed at 0.00x, as Kansai Nerolac has no interest-bearing borrowings, but with leases it rose slightly from 0.0269x to 0.0324x.
- Lease liabilities rose 26.9% (₹171.20 Cr to ₹217.20 Cr), faster than equity at 5.2%.
- It is below the industry average on this measure in both years (industry average 0.05x and 0.05x).

Impact on Financial Risk, Long-Term Obligations and Short-Term Financing

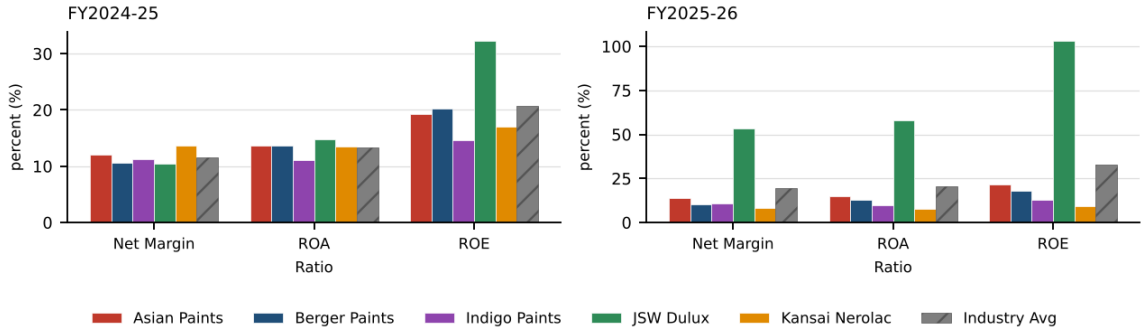
- Financial risk is very low.
- There is substantial room to borrow for a large project or acquisition, and short-term needs are met from its own cash and investments.
- The structure is conservative, but it is also not being used to fund growth.

6.3 Profitability Analysis

Table 12: Profitability

Ratio	Formula used	Asian Paints		Berger Paints		Indigo Paints		JSW Dulux		Kansai Nerolac		Industry Avg	
		FY2024-25	FY2025-26	FY2024-25	FY2025-26	FY2024-25	FY2025-26	FY2024-25	FY2025-26	FY2024-25	FY2025-26	FY2024-25	FY2025-26
Net Profit Margin	Net Profit (PAT) ÷ Revenue from Operations	12.13%	13.79%	10.60%	10.51%	11.27%	10.93%	10.48%	53.28%	13.62%	8.01%	11.62%	19.31%
Return on Assets (ROA) - average basis	Net Profit (PAT) ÷ Average Total Assets (average of prior-year & current-year closing balances, both years)	13.61%	14.96%	13.68%	12.80%	11.16%	9.93%	14.77%	57.85%	13.44%	7.51%	13.33%	20.61%
Return on Equity (ROE) - average basis	Net Profit (PAT) ÷ Average Total Equity (average of prior-year & current-year closing balances, both years)	19.24%	21.35%	20.17%	18.22%	14.66%	13.04%	32.25%	103.02%	16.99%	9.49%	20.66%	33.02%

Figure 8: Profitability ratios (net profit margin, ROA, ROE)



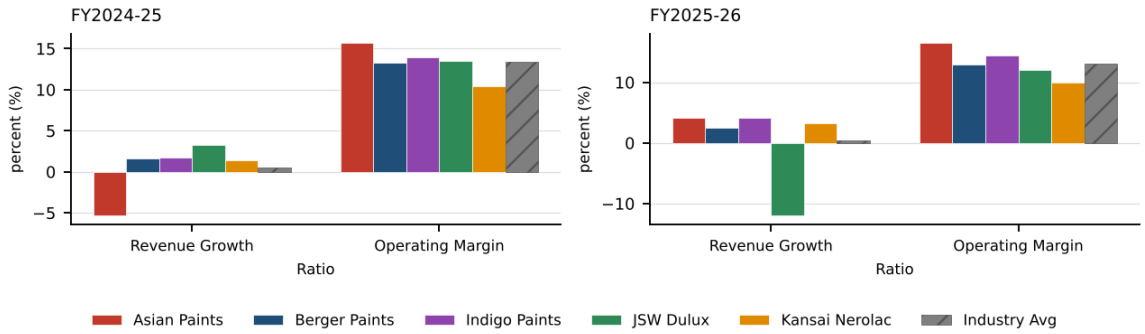
Source: Table 12 above; Excel workbook, Industry Summary sheet. Industry Avg = mean of the five companies.

Inference: Asian Paints is the only company that improved on all three measures, with net profit margin rising from 12.13% to 13.79% and ROE from 19.24% to 21.35%. Berger Paints and Indigo Paints slipped slightly, and Kansai Nerolac fell the most (net margin 13.62% to 8.01%, ROE 16.99% to 9.49%). JSW Dulux's FY2025-26 figures (net margin 53.28%, ROE 103.02%) come from the one-off exceptional gain and are not a normal level of profitability. Because of this, the FY2025-26 Industry Average (net margin 19.31%, ROE 33.02%) is higher than the typical company.

Table 13: Growth and Profitability

Ratio	Formula used	Asian Paints		Berger Paints		Indigo Paints		JSW Dulux		Kansai Nerolac		Industry Avg	
		FY2024-25	FY2025-26	FY2024-25	FY2025-26	FY2024-25	FY2025-26	FY2024-25	FY2025-26	FY2024-25	FY2025-26	FY2024-25	FY2025-26
Revenue Growth (%)	(Current-year Revenue − Previous-year Revenue) ÷ Previous-year Revenue	-5.36%	4.12%	1.66%	2.47%	1.78%	4.14%	3.27%	-12.03%	1.40%	3.24%	0.55%	0.39%
Operating Profit Margin (%)	[Revenue − (Total Expenses − Finance Costs)] ÷ Revenue	15.74%	16.56%	13.34%	12.87%	13.92%	14.38%	13.49%	12.01%	10.41%	9.88%	13.38%	13.14%

Figure 9: Revenue growth and operating profit margin



Source: Table 13 above; Excel workbook, Industry Summary sheet. Industry Avg = mean of the five companies.

Inference: In FY2025-26 revenue grew fastest at Indigo Paints (+4.14%) and Asian Paints (+4.12%), and Asian Paints recovered after a 5.36% fall in FY2024-25. JSW Dulux's revenue fell 12.03%, which pulls the Industry Average growth down to 0.39%. Asian Paints has the highest operating margin (16.56%, rising), and Indigo Paints also improved (13.92% to 14.38%). Berger Paints, JSW Dulux and Kansai Nerolac all had lower margins, with Kansai Nerolac the lowest at 9.88%. Growth in revenue therefore did not always bring a better margin.

Table 14: Profitability Analysis, FY2024-25 → FY2025-26

Company	Net profit margin	Operating profit margin	ROE	Change in profit margin
Asian Paints	12.13% → 13.79%	15.74% → 16.56%	19.24% → 21.35%	Increased
Berger Paints	10.60% → 10.51%	13.34% → 12.87%	20.17% → 18.22%	Slightly lower
Indigo Paints	11.27% → 10.93%	13.92% → 14.38%	14.66% → 13.04%	Net margin lower, operating margin higher
JSW Dulux	10.48% → 53.28%	13.49% → 12.01%	32.25% → 103.02%	Reported margin much higher (one-off); underlying lower
Kansai Nerolac	13.62% → 8.01%	10.41% → 9.88%	16.99% → 9.49%	Lower (mainly a one-off in the base year)

Summary

- On a like-for-like basis only Asian Paints improved its margins.
- Berger Paints and Indigo Paints slipped slightly, Kansai Nerolac's fall is mostly a one-off in the base year with a real margin gap behind it, and JSW Dulux's jump is a one-off gain that hides lower recurring profit.
- Reading the margins without the exceptional items gives a much clearer picture than the headline figures.

Asian Paints

Change in Profit Margin

- Profit margin increased.
- Net profit margin rose from 12.13% to 13.79% and operating profit margin from 15.74% to 16.56%, with ROE up from 19.24% to 21.35%.
- Revenue grew 4.1% but profit after tax grew 18.4% (₹3,584.88 Cr to ₹4,244.17 Cr).
- The cost of materials fell from ₹13,238.32 Cr to ₹12,670.79 Cr while revenue rose, which is consistent with lower raw-material costs reaching profit.
- Exceptional charges also fell, from ₹379.63 Cr to ₹166.53 Cr, so part of the headline gain is smaller one-offs: profit before tax and exceptional items grew 11.8%, against 17.1% reported.

Impact on Short-Term Profitability and Long-Term Growth

- In the short term, Asian Paints keeps more profit from each rupee of sales, and the rise in operating margin shows the gain is not only from smaller one-offs.
- For long-term growth, a leading margin on a much larger base gives it more room to invest than its peers.
- Asian Paints' ROE of 21.35% looks well below the FY2025-26 industry average (33.02%) only because the average is lifted by JSW Dulux's one-off gain.

Berger Paints

Change in Profit Margin

- Profit margin was roughly flat to slightly lower.
- Net profit margin moved from 10.60% to 10.51% and operating profit margin from 13.34% to 12.87%, while ROA fell from 13.68% to 12.80% and ROE from 20.17% to 18.22%.
- Revenue grew 2.5% and profit after tax 1.7%, so costs grew slightly faster than sales.
- FY2025-26 also carries a ₹49.99 Cr exceptional charge (the new Labour Codes), without which profit before tax would have been ₹1,488.21 Cr instead of ₹1,438.22 Cr.
- Average equity grew faster than profit, which lowers ROE.

Impact on Short-Term Profitability and Long-Term Growth

- In the short term, Berger Paints earns slightly less on each rupee of sales, and its operating margin is a little below the industry average in both years.
- For the long term, assets and equity growing ahead of profit is consistent with capacity and balance-sheet strength being built before returns catch up, rather than a loss of market position.
- The dip is mild and mostly operational, with only the small FY2025-26 exceptional charge as a one-off.

Indigo Paints

Change in Profit Margin

- Net profit margin decreased but operating profit margin increased.
- Net margin fell from 11.27% to 10.93% while operating margin rose from 13.92% to 14.38%, and ROE fell from 14.66% to 13.04%.
- Revenue grew 4.1% but profit after tax only 1.0% (₹143.94 Cr to ₹145.39 Cr).
- Because operating margin improved, the slip happened below the operating line, in items such as the ₹5.85 Cr exceptional charge in FY2025-26, not in the core business.

Impact on Short-Term Profitability and Long-Term Growth

- In the short term, profit is growing more slowly than sales.
- For the long term, the improving operating margin shows growth has not cost efficiency, and the lower ROE is consistent with a company still building out its network in smaller towns (Section 2), where scale benefits have not yet caught up with the larger competitors.
- Asset turnover also fell, from 0.99x to 0.91x.

JSW Dulux

Change in Profit Margin

- The reported margin increased sharply, but the underlying margin decreased.
- Net profit margin jumped from 10.48% to 53.28% and ROE from 32.25% to 103.02%, but this comes from a ₹1,846.30 Cr one-off net gain, mainly from the sale of two divisions.
- Without it, profit before tax was ₹453.40 Cr, which is 20.4% lower than the ₹569.70 Cr of FY2024-25.
- Revenue fell 12.0% (₹4,091.20 Cr to ₹3,599.20 Cr) and operating margin fell from 13.49% to 12.01%.

Impact on Short-Term Profitability and Long-Term Growth

- In the short term, the headline profit will not repeat, and recurring profit is lower.
- For the long term, the company is smaller after the divisions left, and it is going through the change to JSW Paints; the workbook shows the weaker operating margin in the same period but does not show that the ownership change caused it.
- Operating margin is the better guide to JSW Dulux's profitability than net margin, and the FY2024-25 figures are the more representative recent result.

Kansai Nerolac

Change in Profit Margin

- Profit margin decreased, mainly because of a one-off in the base year.
- Net profit margin fell from 13.62% to 8.01%, ROE from 16.99% to 9.49%, and operating margin from 10.41% to 9.88%.
- FY2024-25 profit before tax of ₹1,386.61 Cr included a ₹479.19 Cr exceptional gain on the sale of its Lower Parel factory land, and FY2025-26 carried a ₹60.70 Cr net exceptional charge.

- Before exceptional items, profit before tax was almost unchanged (₹907.42 Cr to ₹898.91 Cr, 0.9% lower).

Impact on Short-Term Profitability and Long-Term Growth

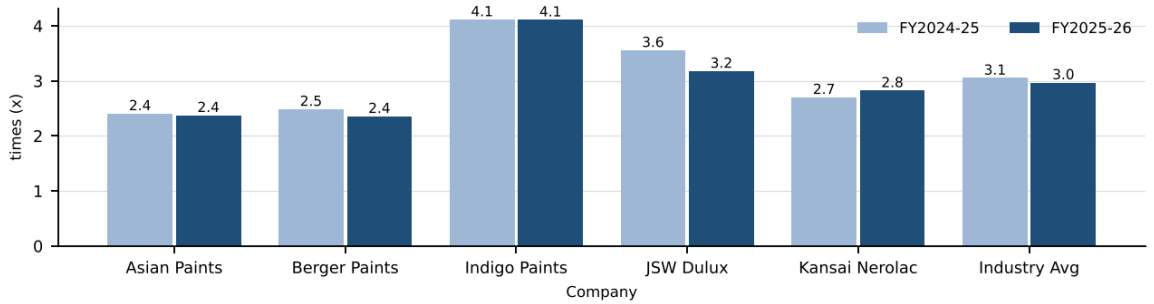
- In the short term, the reported fall overstates the weakening, but the operating margin of 9.88% is still the lowest of the five and below the industry average (13.14%), so there is a real margin gap.
- For the long term, flat underlying profit on revenue growth of 3.2% is consistent with its heavier mix of automotive and industrial coatings (Section 2), a slower and more cyclical segment than decorative paints, which may limit growth compared with Asian Paints and Berger Paints.

6.4 Inventory and Turnover Analysis

Table 15: Efficiency and Turnover

Ratio	Formula used	Asian Paints		Berger Paints		Indigo Paints		JSW Dulux		Kansai Nerolac		Industry Avg	
		FY2024-25	FY2025-26	FY2024-25	FY2025-26	FY2024-25	FY2025-26	FY2024-25	FY2025-26	FY2024-25	FY2025-26	FY2024-25	FY2025-26
Materials-Consumption Turnover - average basis	Cost of Materials Consumed ÷ Average Inventories (named explicitly as a proxy - none of the three companies discloses a single consolidated COGS line; average of prior-year & current-year closing inventory, both years)	2.41x	2.37x	2.49x	2.36x	4.11x	4.11x	3.56x	3.18x	2.70x	2.82x	3.05x	2.97x

Figure 10: Materials-consumption turnover



Source: Table 15 above; Excel workbook, Industry Summary sheet. Industry Avg = mean of the five companies.

Inference: Indigo Paints turns over its materials inventory fastest (4.11x in both years), followed by JSW Dulux, although JSW Dulux slowed from 3.56x to 3.18x. Asian Paints and Berger Paints are slightly lower and edged down, while Kansai Nerolac improved from 2.70x to 2.82x. Higher turnover means stock is used up more quickly. The Industry Average eased from 3.05x to 2.97x.

Table 16: Inventory and Turnover Analysis, FY2024-25 → FY2025-26

Company	Inventory (₹ Cr)	Inventory as % of current assets	Materials-consumption turnover	Change in turnover
Asian Paints	5,848.23 → 4,824.74	40.9% → 28.0%	2.41x → 2.37x	Decreased slightly
Berger Paints	2,206.60 → 2,225.60	53.4% → 47.6%	2.49x → 2.36x	Decreased
Indigo Paints	149.13 → 173.07	23.1% → 22.7%	4.11x → 4.11x	Unchanged
JSW Dulux	604.70 → 571.10	30.2% → 33.2%	3.56x → 3.18x	Decreased
Kansai Nerolac	1,609.71 → 1,492.92	31.1% → 26.6%	2.70x → 2.82x	Increased

Summary

- Indigo Paints turns its stock fastest and is unchanged.
- Kansai Nerolac is the only company whose turnover improved.
- Asian Paints, Berger Paints and JSW Dulux slowed, with Asian Paints and Berger Paints the slowest of the five.
- Stock is about half of Berger Paints' current assets but only about a quarter of Indigo Paints' and Kansai Nerolac's, which is why liquidity depends more on stock for Berger Paints.

Asian Paints

Inventory Level and Liquidity

- Inventory was ₹5,848.23 Cr at the end of FY2024-25 and ₹4,824.74 Cr at the end of FY2025-26, which is 40.9% and 28.0% of current assets.
- Inventory counts in the current ratio but not in the quick ratio, so a falling stock raised the quick ratio (1.36x to 1.77x) and released ₹1,023.49 Cr of working capital.

Change in Inventory Turnover and Its Implications

- Inventory turnover decreased slightly, from 2.41x to 2.37x.
- The cost of materials fell 4.3% while average inventory fell 3.0%, so stock moved a little more slowly compared with usage.
- Asian Paints is below the industry average (3.05x and 2.97x), which is consistent with its larger scale and wider product range.
- The financial effect is small: the stock reduction matters more for liquidity than the small fall in turnover.

Berger Paints

Inventory Level and Liquidity

- Inventory was ₹2,206.60 Cr then ₹2,225.60 Cr, which is 53.4% and 47.6% of current assets, so about half of current assets is stock.
- Because stock is excluded from the quick ratio, the quick ratio (0.97x to 1.15x) is much lower than the current ratio (2.08x to 2.18x), and the improvement came from other current assets, not from selling stock.

Change in Inventory Turnover and Its Implications

- Inventory turnover decreased, from 2.49x to 2.36x.
- The cost of materials fell 0.6% while average inventory rose 4.9%, so stock turned over more slowly.
- Berger Paints is below the industry average (3.05x and 2.97x), so more capital stays tied up in stock than at the average company, and the gap widened slightly.
- This is a modest, continuing inefficiency, worth watching.

Indigo Paints

Inventory Level and Liquidity

- Inventory rose from ₹149.13 Cr to ₹173.07 Cr, which is 23.1% and 22.7% of current assets.
- Stock is a smaller part of current assets than at Berger Paints or Asian Paints, so the current ratio (2.40x to 2.23x) and quick ratio (1.84x to 1.72x) are close together and liquidity depends less on stock.

Change in Inventory Turnover and Its Implications

- Inventory turnover was unchanged at 4.11x and 4.11x, the highest of the five and well above the industry average (3.05x and 2.97x).
- The cost of materials grew 2.1% and average inventory 2.2%, so stock grew in line with usage.
- High turnover means little money is tied up in stock, which supports liquidity, and is consistent with a demand-led model focused on smaller towns.

JSW Dulux

Inventory Level and Liquidity

- Inventory eased from ₹604.70 Cr to ₹571.10 Cr, which is 30.2% and 33.2% of current assets.
- Stock is about a third of current assets, which is why the current ratio (1.52x) is well above the quick ratio (1.01x).
- The quick ratio rose because current liabilities fell faster than current assets other than stock.

Change in Inventory Turnover and Its Implications

- Inventory turnover decreased, from 3.56x to 3.18x.
- The cost of materials fell 13.6% but average inventory fell only 3.3%, which fits the period after the divisions were sold: their material use left the profit and loss account faster than their stock left the balance sheet.
- It is still above the industry average (3.05x and 2.97x).
- It is a mild and probably temporary drag, and the question is whether turnover recovers once stock matches the smaller business.

Kansai Nerolac

Inventory Level and Liquidity

- Inventory fell from ₹1,609.71 Cr to ₹1,492.92 Cr, which is 31.1% and 26.6% of current assets.
- Stock is a smaller share of current assets than at Berger Paints, so liquidity does not depend on selling stock, and the quick ratio stays high (2.77x and 2.75x).

Change in Inventory Turnover and Its Implications

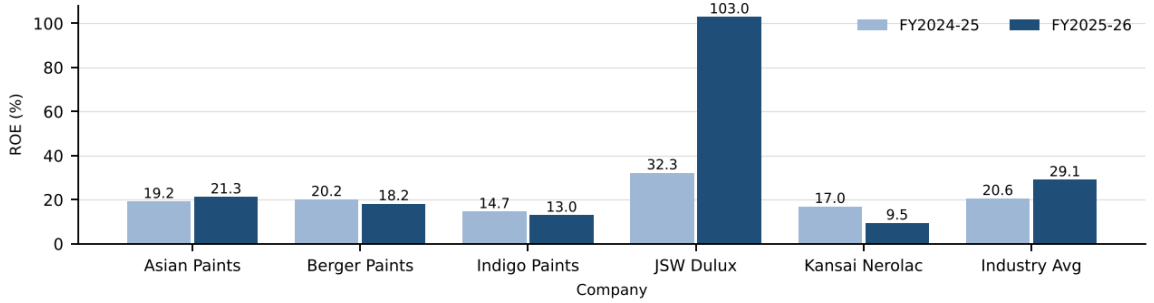
- Inventory turnover increased, from 2.70x to 2.82x.
- The cost of materials grew only 0.6% while average inventory fell 3.8%, so it is running leaner stock, which is a real efficiency gain.
- It is still below the industry average (3.05x and 2.97x) but the gap has narrowed.
- It is the one area where Kansai Nerolac improved while its reported profit ratios fell.

6.5 DuPont Analysis

Table 17: 3-Factor DuPont Analysis (ROE decomposition)

Ratio	Formula used	Asian Paints		Berger Paints		Indigo Paints		JSW Dulux		Kansai Nerolac		Industry Avg	
		FY2024-25	FY2025-26	FY2024-25	FY2025-26	FY2024-25	FY2025-26	FY2024-25	FY2025-26	FY2024-25	FY2025-26	FY2024-25	FY2025-26
Net Profit Margin	PAT ÷ Revenue	12.13%	13.79%	10.60%	10.51%	11.27%	10.93%	10.48%	53.28%	13.62%	8.01%	11.62%	19.31%
Asset Turnover	Revenue ÷ Average Total Assets	1.12x	1.08x	1.29x	1.22x	0.99x	0.91x	1.41x	1.09x	0.99x	0.94x	1.16x	1.05x
Equity Multiplier	Average Total Assets ÷ Average Total Equity	1.41x	1.43x	1.47x	1.42x	1.31x	1.31x	2.18x	1.78x	1.26x	1.26x	1.53x	1.44x
ROE (product)	Net Margin × Asset Turnover × Equity Multiplier	**19.24%**	**21.35%**	**20.17%**	**18.22%**	**14.66%**	**13.04%**	**32.25%**	**103.02%**	**16.99%**	**9.49%**	**20.62%**	**29.13%**

Figure 11: Return on equity (3-factor DuPont product) by company



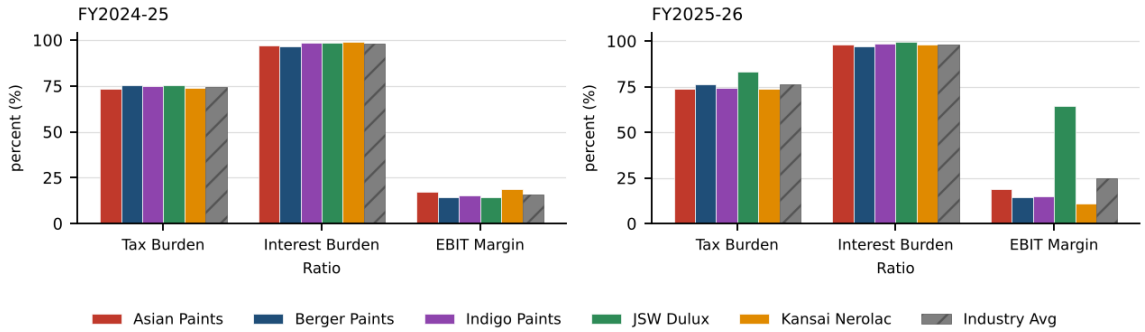
Source: Table 17 above; Excel workbook, Industry Summary sheet. Industry Avg = mean of the five companies.

Inference: Asian Paints' ROE rose because its net margin improved, even though its asset turnover slipped from 1.12x to 1.08x. Berger Paints' ROE fell as its margin, asset turnover and equity multiplier all eased slightly. Kansai Nerolac's fall in ROE is mainly a fall in net margin (13.62% to 8.01%). JSW Dulux's ROE of 103.02% is driven by its 53.28% net margin, which includes the one-off gain. The averaged factors multiply to 29.13%, compared with 33.02% for the average of the five ROE figures, so the Industry Average ROE depends on how it is calculated.

Table 18: 5-Factor DuPont Analysis (ROE decomposition)

Ratio	Formula used	Asian Paints		Berger Paints		Indigo Paints		JSW Dulux		Kansai Nerolac		Industry Avg	
		FY2024-25	FY2025-26	FY2024-25	FY2025-26	FY2024-25	FY2025-26	FY2024-25	FY2025-26	FY2024-25	FY2025-26	FY2024-25	FY2025-26
Tax Burden	Net Profit (PAT) ÷ Profit Before Tax (PBT)	73.20%	74.02%	75.31%	76.18%	74.88%	74.46%	75.23%	83.39%	73.65%	73.95%	74.46%	76.40%
Interest Burden	PBT ÷ EBIT (EBIT = PBT + Finance Costs)	97.15%	97.83%	96.76%	96.93%	98.48%	98.79%	98.31%	99.48%	98.92%	97.85%	97.93%	98.17%
EBIT Margin	EBIT ÷ Revenue from Operations	17.06%	19.05%	14.54%	14.24%	15.28%	14.86%	14.16%	64.23%	18.70%	11.07%	15.95%	24.69%
Asset Turnover	Revenue ÷ Average Total Assets (as in the 3-Factor DuPont analysis above)	1.12x	1.08x	1.29x	1.22x	0.99x	0.91x	1.41x	1.09x	0.99x	0.94x	1.16x	1.05x
Equity Multiplier	Average Total Assets ÷ Average Total Equity (as in the 3-Factor DuPont analysis above)	1.41x	1.43x	1.47x	1.42x	1.31x	1.31x	2.18x	1.78x	1.26x	1.26x	1.53x	1.44x
5-Factor DuPont ROE (product)	Tax Burden × Interest Burden × EBIT Margin × Asset Turnover × Equity Multiplier	**19.24%**	**21.35%**	**20.17%**	**18.22%**	**14.66%**	**13.04%**	**32.25%**	**103.02%**	**16.99%**	**9.49%**	**20.64%**	**27.94%**
Directly-Calculated ROE (existing, above)	Net Profit (PAT) ÷ Average Total Equity - same figure as the Ratio Analysis / 3-Factor DuPont ROE above	19.24%	21.35%	20.17%	18.22%	14.66%	13.04%	32.25%	103.02%	16.99%	9.49%	20.66%	33.02%
Reconciliation Difference	5-Factor DuPont ROE – Directly-Calculated ROE (should be ~0.00%)	0.0000%	0.0000%	0.0000%	0.0000%	0.0000%	0.0000%	0.0000%	0.0000%	0.0000%	0.0000%	-0.0270%	-5.0794%

Figure 12: 5-factor DuPont: tax burden, interest burden and EBIT margin



Source: Table 18 above; Excel workbook, Industry Summary sheet. Industry Avg = mean of the five companies.

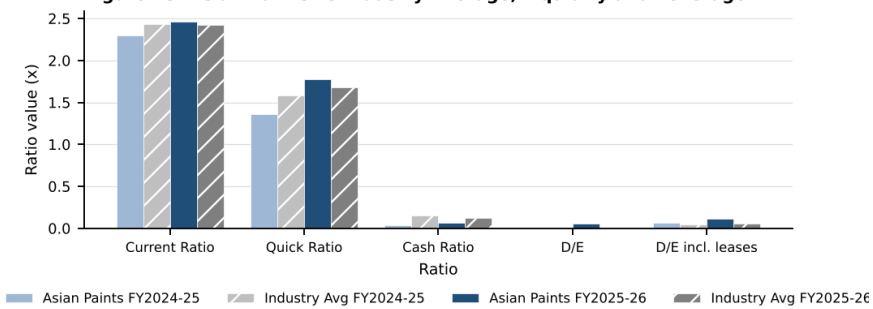
Inference. The tax burden is similar for most companies (about 0.73 to 0.76), and the interest burden is close to 1, which means little profit is lost to interest. The main differences in ROE therefore come from EBIT margin and turnover. Asian Paints' EBIT margin rose from 17.06% to 19.05%, while Kansai Nerolac's fell from 18.70% to 11.07%. JSW Dulux's EBIT margin of 64.23% and higher tax burden of 0.83 reflect the exceptional gain. The five-factor ROE matches the directly calculated ROE for every company, with a difference of 0.0000%; only the Industry Average shows a difference, because averaged factors are multiplied.

Overall, the two DuPont models show that ROE is influenced by both operating performance and the efficiency with which assets and equity are used. The 3-Factor analysis highlights the role of net profit margin, asset turnover and the equity multiplier, while the 5-Factor analysis further separates the effects of taxation and interest costs from operating profitability. For most companies, the tax and interest burdens are relatively similar, making EBIT margin and asset turnover more useful for explaining differences in performance. JSW Dulux is an exception because its one-off gain substantially inflates its profit-based measures in FY2025-26. Therefore, its reported ROE should not be treated as representative of its recurring operating performance.

Company vs Industry Average

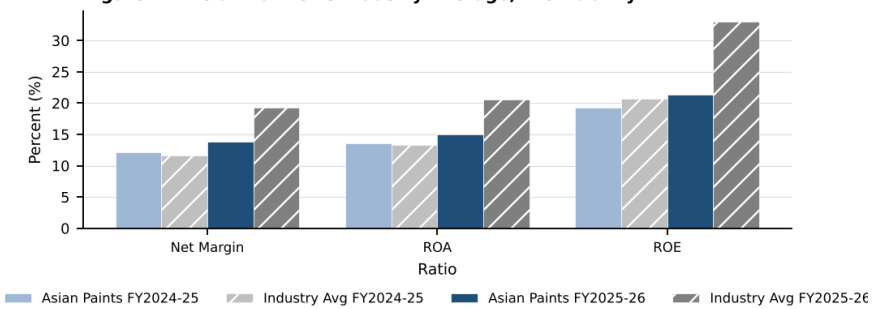
These graphs repeat the company-versus-industry charts in the Excel workbook. Each company has two graphs, one for liquidity and leverage and one for profitability, with the company and the Industry Average side by side for both years.

Figure 13: Asian Paints vs Industry Average, Liquidity and Leverage



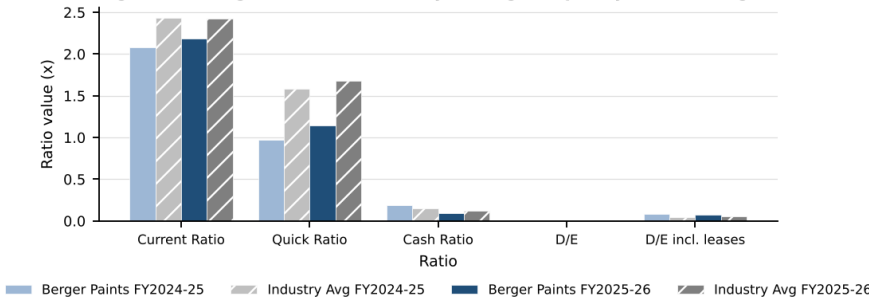
Source: Excel workbook, Asian Paints sheet, section I. Industry Avg = mean of the five companies.

Figure 14: Asian Paints vs Industry Average, Profitability



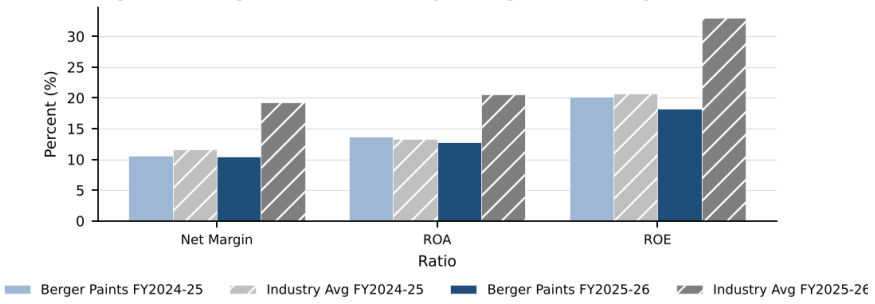
Source: Excel workbook, Asian Paints sheet, section I. Industry Avg = mean of the five companies.

Figure 15: Berger Paints vs Industry Average, Liquidity and Leverage



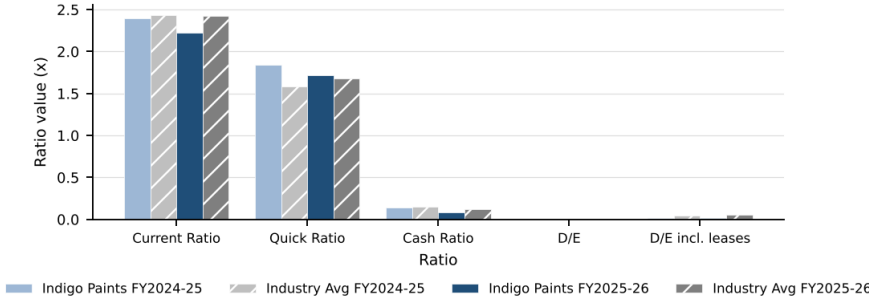
Source: Excel workbook, Berger Paints sheet, section I. Industry Avg = mean of the five companies.

Figure 16: Berger Paints vs Industry Average, Profitability



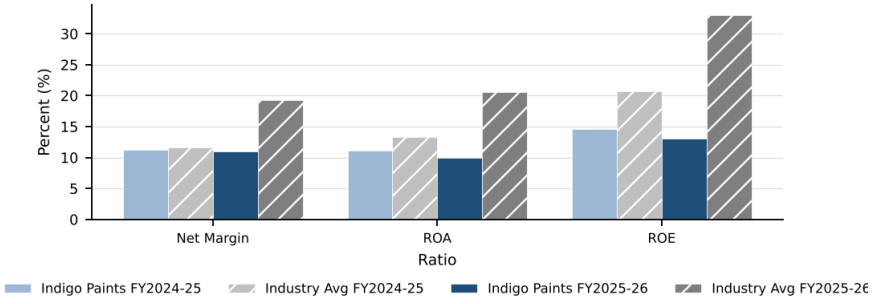
Source: Excel workbook, Berger Paints sheet, section I. Industry Avg = mean of the five companies.

Figure 17: Indigo Paints vs Industry Average, Liquidity and Leverage



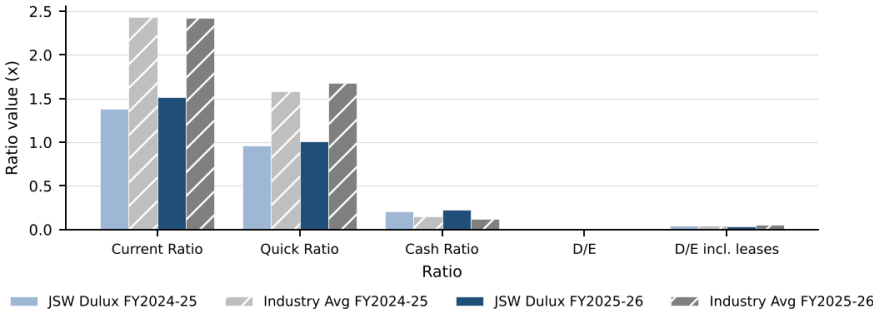
Source: Excel workbook, Indigo Paints sheet, section I. Industry Avg = mean of the five companies.

Figure 18: Indigo Paints vs Industry Average, Profitability



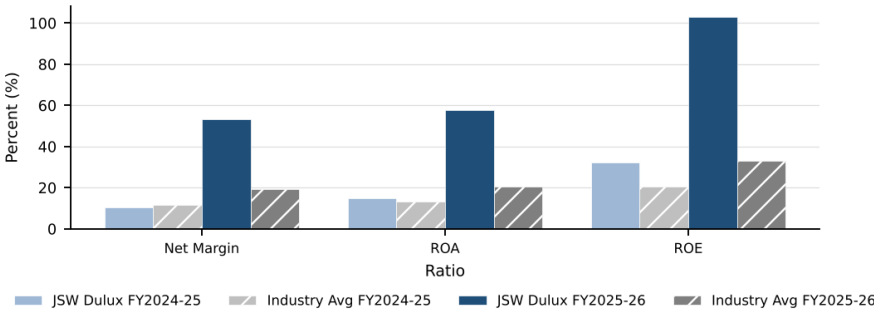
Source: Excel workbook, Indigo Paints sheet, section I. Industry Avg = mean of the five companies.

Figure 19: JSW Dulux vs Industry Average, Liquidity and Leverage



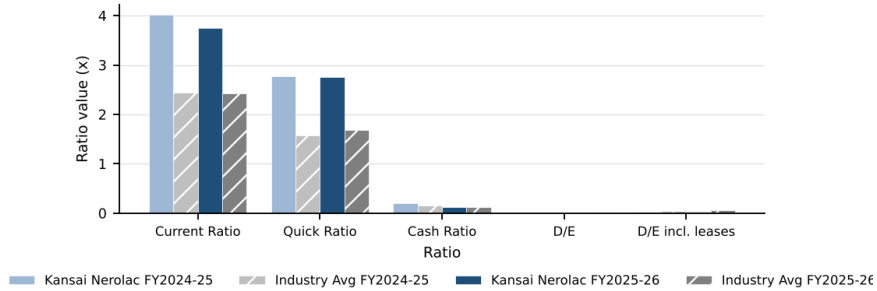
Source: Excel workbook, JSW Dulux sheet, section I. Industry Avg = mean of the five companies.

Figure 20: JSW Dulux vs Industry Average, Profitability



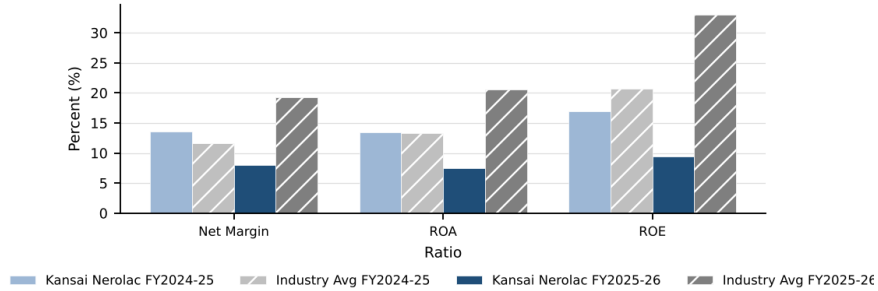
Source: Excel workbook, JSW Dulux sheet, section I. Industry Avg = mean of the five companies.

Figure 21: Kansai Nerolac vs Industry Average, Liquidity and Leverage



Source: Excel workbook, Kansai Nerolac sheet, section I. Industry Avg = mean of the five companies.

Figure 22: Kansai Nerolac vs Industry Average, Profitability



Source: Excel workbook, Kansai Nerolac sheet, section I. Industry Avg = mean of the five companies.

Inference. Compared with the Industry Average, Kansai Nerolac has much higher liquidity but lower profitability in FY2025-26. Asian Paints is at or above the average on the current and quick ratios and has improved its profitability. Berger Paints is below the average on liquidity and on profitability. Indigo Paints is close to the average on liquidity and below it on profitability. JSW Dulux has lower liquidity but is far above the average on profitability only because of the one-off gain. The Industry Average profitability in FY2025-26 is itself lifted by that gain.

Year-wise Comparison with the Industry Average

For each company and each year, these are the measures on which the company was above or below the Industry Average, taken from Tables 8 to 14.

Table 19: Year-wise Comparison with the Industry Average, FY2024-25

Company	Above Industry Average	Below Industry Average
Asian Paints	Net Profit Margin, Return on Assets (ROA), Operating Profit Margin	Current Ratio, Quick Ratio, Return on Equity (ROE), Materials-Consumption Turnover, Revenue Growth
Berger Paints	Return on Assets (ROA), Revenue Growth	Current Ratio, Quick Ratio, Net Profit Margin, Return on Equity (ROE), Materials-Consumption Turnover, Operating Profit Margin
Indigo Paints	Quick Ratio, Materials-Consumption Turnover, Revenue Growth, Operating Profit Margin	Current Ratio, Net Profit Margin, Return on Assets (ROA), Return on Equity (ROE)
JSW Dulux	Return on Assets (ROA), Return on Equity (ROE), Materials-Consumption Turnover, Revenue Growth, Operating Profit Margin	Current Ratio, Quick Ratio, Net Profit Margin
Kansai Nerolac	Current Ratio, Quick Ratio, Net Profit Margin, Return on Assets (ROA), Revenue Growth	Return on Equity (ROE), Materials-Consumption Turnover, Operating Profit Margin

Table 20: Year-wise Comparison with the Industry Average, FY2025-26

Company	Above Industry Average	Below Industry Average
Asian Paints	Current Ratio, Quick Ratio, Revenue Growth, Operating Profit Margin	Net Profit Margin, Return on Assets (ROA), Return on Equity (ROE), Materials-Consumption Turnover
Berger Paints	Revenue Growth	Current Ratio, Quick Ratio, Net Profit Margin, Return on Assets (ROA), Return on Equity (ROE), Materials-Consumption Turnover, Operating Profit Margin
Indigo Paints	Quick Ratio, Materials-Consumption Turnover, Revenue Growth, Operating Profit Margin	Current Ratio, Net Profit Margin, Return on Assets (ROA), Return on Equity (ROE)
JSW Dulux	Net Profit Margin, Return on Assets (ROA), Return on Equity (ROE), Materials-Consumption Turnover	Current Ratio, Quick Ratio, Revenue Growth, Operating Profit Margin
Kansai Nerolac	Current Ratio, Quick Ratio, Revenue Growth	Net Profit Margin, Return on Assets (ROA), Return on Equity (ROE), Materials-Consumption Turnover, Operating Profit Margin

Note: The comparison is based on the Industry Average calculated across the five companies. Being above the Industry Average does not necessarily indicate better performance, as the interpretation depends on the nature of the ratio. JSW Dulux's one-off exceptional gain significantly raises the FY2025-26 Industry Average for profit-based measures.

Conclusion on Company Performance

Asian Paints is the strongest of the five. Its margins and ROE improved in FY2025-26, its revenue recovered after the FY2024-25 fall (to +4.12%), and its liquidity moved above the average. It looks below average on net margin and ROE in FY2025-26 only because the average is lifted by JSW Dulux's one-off gain.

Berger Paints is stable but slipping a little. Its margins and ROE edged down in FY2025-26, it is below the average on liquidity in both years, and in FY2025-26 it is above the average only on revenue growth (+2.47%). It has very little borrowing.

Indigo Paints has the fastest stock turnover of the five (4.11x) and the highest revenue growth in FY2025-26 (+4.14%), and its operating margin improved from 13.92% to 14.38%. Its ROA (11.16% to 9.93%) and ROE (14.66% to 13.04%) fell, and both are below the average.

JSW Dulux's FY2025-26 profit measures (net margin 53.28%, ROE 103.02%) are far above the average only because of the one-off exceptional gain. Its core position is weaker: revenue fell 12.03%, operating margin fell from 13.49% to 12.01%, and it has the lowest current ratio of the five in both years (1.38x and 1.52x).

Kansai Nerolac has the strongest liquidity of the five (current ratio 4.02x and 3.75x), but its profitability fell clearly in FY2025-26: net margin from 13.62% to 8.01%, operating margin from 10.41% to 9.88% and ROE from 16.99% to 9.49%. Its FY2024-25 profit included a ₹479.19 Cr exceptional gain, so part of the fall is a one-off item dropping out.

Taken together, Asian Paints is the leader, Berger Paints is steady, Indigo Paints is smaller but growing, and Kansai Nerolac and JSW Dulux have weakened. This agrees with the leaders and laggards in Section 3.

Notes: JSW Dulux's FY2025-26 net profit margin, ROA, ROE and EBIT margin include a one-off exceptional gain (mainly the profit on the sale of two divisions) and lift the FY2025-26 Industry Average. The DuPont Industry Average ROE multiplies the averaged factors, so it differs slightly from the average of the five companies' own ROE; the reconciliation difference is shown in Table 18. Debt-to-Equity uses interest-bearing borrowings only.

8. References

This section lists the sources used in the report. For the annual reports, the printed page numbers are as printed in each report and the PDF page is the page of the PDF file. The pages are reproduced in the Annexure (Section 9).

8.1 Annual Reports

The financial statement data in Section 5 and the ratios in Section 6 are taken from the standalone Balance Sheet and Statement of Profit and Loss in the annual reports below. The company profile details (Table 1) are taken from the FY2025-26 reports; the pages used are listed in Section 9.

[1] **Berger Paints India Limited.** Integrated Annual Report 2025-26. Balance Sheet printed p.296 and Statement of Profit and Loss printed p.297 (PDF page 150).

[2] **Berger Paints India Limited.** Integrated Annual Report 2024-25. Balance Sheet printed p.302 and Statement of Profit and Loss printed p.303 (PDF page 153).

[3] **Asian Paints Limited.** Integrated Annual Report 2025-26. Balance Sheet printed p.364 and Statement of Profit and Loss printed p.365 (PDF page 184).

[4] **Asian Paints Limited.** Integrated Annual Report 2024-25. Balance Sheet printed p.350 and Statement of Profit and Loss printed p.351 (PDF page 177).

[5] **Indigo Paints Limited.** 26th Annual Report 2025-26. Balance Sheet printed p.148 and Statement of Profit and Loss printed p.149 (PDF pages 124-125).

[6] **Indigo Paints Limited.** 25th Annual Report 2024-25. Balance Sheet printed p.138 and Statement of Profit and Loss printed p.139 (PDF pages 140-141).

[7] **JSW Dulux Limited.** Annual Report 2025-26. Balance Sheet printed p.112 and Statement of Profit and Loss printed p.113 (PDF page 58).

[8] **Akzo Nobel India Limited (now JSW Dulux Limited).** Annual Report 2024-25. Balance Sheet printed p.112 and Statement of Profit and Loss printed p.113 (PDF pages 114-115).

[9] **Kansai Nerolac Paints Limited.** Annual Report 2025-26. Balance Sheet printed p.270 and Statement of Profit and Loss printed p.271 (PDF pages 272-273).

[10] **Kansai Nerolac Paints Limited.** Annual Report 2024-25. Balance Sheet printed p.274 and Statement of Profit and Loss printed p.275 (PDF pages 276-277).

8.2 Industry Classification and Secondary Sources

[11] **Industry classification.** National Industrial Classification (NIC) 2008, code 20221, Manufacture of paints, varnishes, enamels or lacquers, as reported in the FY2025-26 annual report of each of the five companies (Section 2).

[12] **ACMIIL Institutional Research.** Paints – Sector Initiating Report, Exhibit 4 (FY24 share of the top five paint companies' consolidated revenue, based on company filings). Used for the comparison in Table 6 (Section 4.4).

[13] **Ministry of Corporate Affairs (MCA) company master data, via InstaFinancials.** Exact dates of incorporation of Asian Paints, Kansai Nerolac and JSW Dulux (Table 1).

[14] **VentureIntelligence coverage reported by ghar.tv (2 February 2022).** Corporate headquarters of Kansai Nerolac (Table 1).

[15] **JSW Dulux Limited, company filing to NSE and BSE, 2 April 2026.** Corporate office of JSW Dulux (Table 1).

8.3 Market Data

[16] **NSE and BSE daily historical data.** Monthly closing share prices, April 2021 to March 2026, as recorded in the accompanying Excel workbook (Section 4).

[17] **Screener.in.** Market capitalisation as of 9 October 2026 (Section 4.3).

[18] **Company filings, investor communications and stock-exchange announcements.** Dividend per share and dividend status as of 12 October 2026 (Table 1 and its note).

8.4 Accompanying Workbook

[19] **Team workbook.** FAA_Final_Student_Style.xlsx. The Industry Summary sheet holds the financial statement data, the ratios, the DuPont analysis and the Industry Average (simple mean of the five companies) used in Sections 3, 5 and 6; the company sheets (Berger, Kansai Nerolac, Asian Paints, Indigo Paints and JSW Dulux) hold each company's inputs and monthly share prices.

9. Annexure – Annual Report Pages of the Financial Statements

This annexure reproduces the pages of the annual reports from which the financial statement figures used in this report were taken. For each company the Balance Sheet and the Statement of Profit and Loss are shown as they appear in the FY2025-26 and FY2024-25 annual reports. The FY2025-26 reports give both years side by side. The FY2024-25 reports give the 31 March 2024 opening balances and the FY2024-25 figures as originally reported; this matters for Asian Paints, whose FY2025-26 report restates its FY2024-25 comparatives.

Source Pages Used for the Company Profile (Table 1)

Source pages (annual reports used for Table 1): Printed page numbers are as printed in each report; "PDF p." is the page of the PDF file.

Berger Paints: Annual Report 2025-26 - Corporate Information page, printed p.108 (CIN, Registered Office); BRSR General Disclosures, printed p.182 (Registered Office, NIC classification); Board of Directors page, printed pp.46-47 (Chairman, Managing Director & CEO); Financial Highlights, printed pp.64-65 (dividend per share, FY2025-26). The report states only the year of incorporation, 1923.

Asian Paints: Integrated Annual Report 2025-26 - BRSR, PDF p.157 (CIN, Registered Office, year of incorporation); Chairman's Letter, PDF p.14 (Chairman); MD & CEO's message, PDF p.16 (Managing Director & CEO); Board's Report - Dividend, printed pp.214-215 (FY2025-26 dividend).

Indigo Paints: Annual Report 2025-26 (26th Annual Report) - BRSR, printed p.106 (CIN, Registered Office, exact date of incorporation); Board's Report, printed p.63 (FY2025-26 dividend); Board of Directors profiles / Notice to Members (Chairman, Managing Director).

JSW Dulux: Annual Report 2025-26 - Secretarial Audit Report, printed p.35 (CIN, Registered Office); Board of Directors profiles, printed p.20 (Chairman); Form AOC-1 signatures, PDF p.50 (Joint Managing Director & CEO); Report of the Directors, PDF p.14 (change of name); Chairman's overview, printed p.5, and Notes to Financial Statements - Dividend, PDF p.78 (FY2025-26 dividend). Akzo Nobel India Annual Report 2024-25 - Recent Years at a Glance, printed pp.13-14 (dividends FY2021-22 to FY2024-25).

Kansai Nerolac: Annual Report 2025-26 - BRSR, printed p.221 (CIN, Registered Office, year of incorporation); Notes to Standalone Financial Statements, Related Party Disclosures (Note 39), PDF p.311 (Chairman, Managing Director); Summarised Standalone Statement of Profit and Loss of 15 Years, printed p.392 (dividends FY2021-22 to FY2025-26).

Other sources: Exact dates of incorporation of Asian Paints, Kansai Nerolac and JSW Dulux are from MCA company master data (via InstaFinancials). Kansai Nerolac corporate headquarters: VentureIntelligence coverage reported by ghar.tv (2 February 2022). JSW Dulux corporate office: company filing to NSE/BSE, 2 April 2026.